

Supertitle Cuer

User Guide

by **poetic PiXie**

Version 1.0.0

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Supertitle Cuer

by **poetic PiXie**



Supertitle Cuer — **STQ** for short — makes running opera supertitles calm and simple. It works right from the score: you mark numbered cues on the score PDF where each title should appear, pair them with your titles, and during the performance one key — or a clicker — puts the next title on the projector, in time with the music. STQ can also listen to the performance and show an estimated countdown to the next cue.

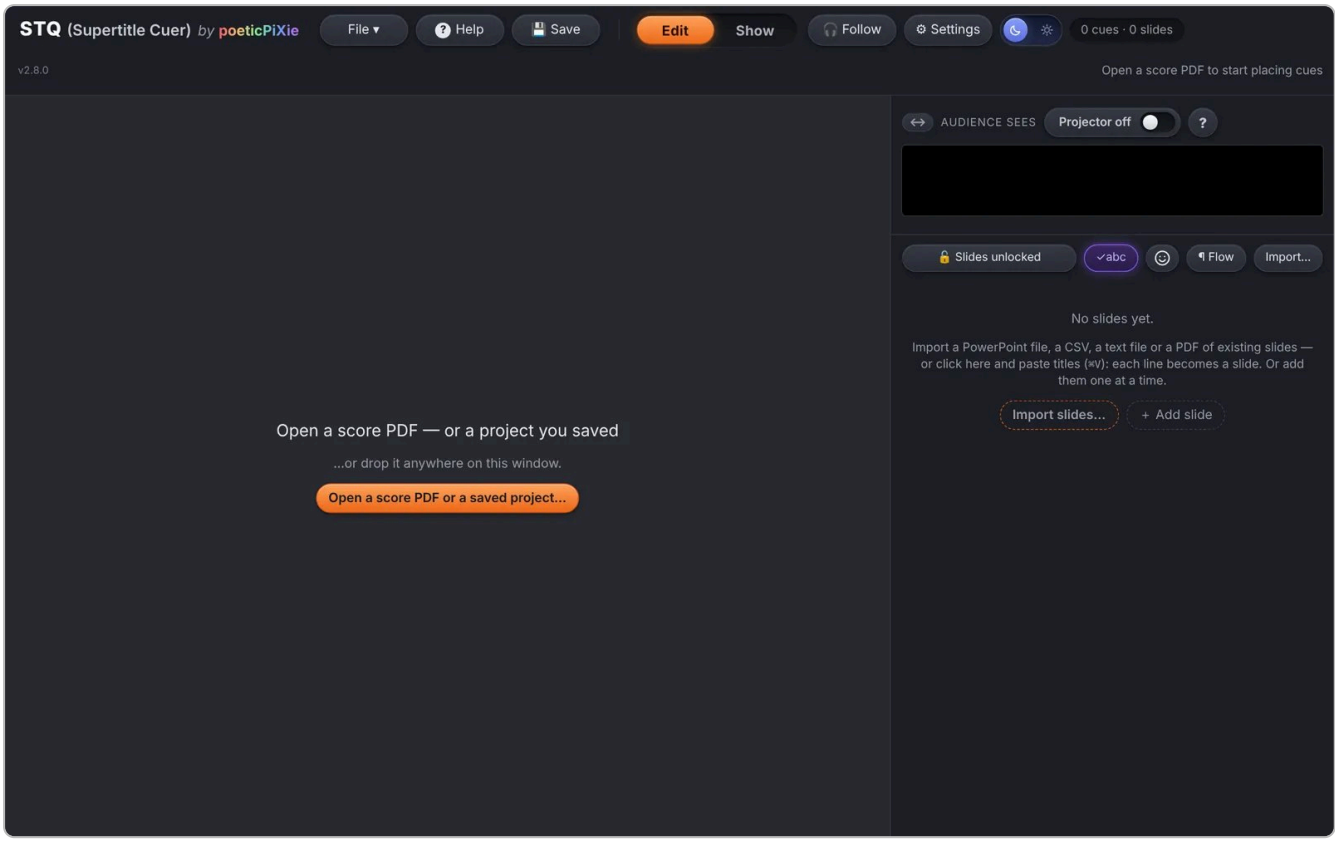
This guide starts with a Quick start that walks through a real project, the Anvil Chorus from Verdi's *Il trovatore*, from an empty window to titles on the screen. The chapters after it explain every button and panel in detail — dip in whenever you want to know more. Enjoy the show!

Quick start: titles on the screen in ten minutes

From an empty window to titles on the projector — easier than it sounds, and done in the order most people work: titles first, then the score, then the cues. (Any order works — the cues and titles pair up by number.)

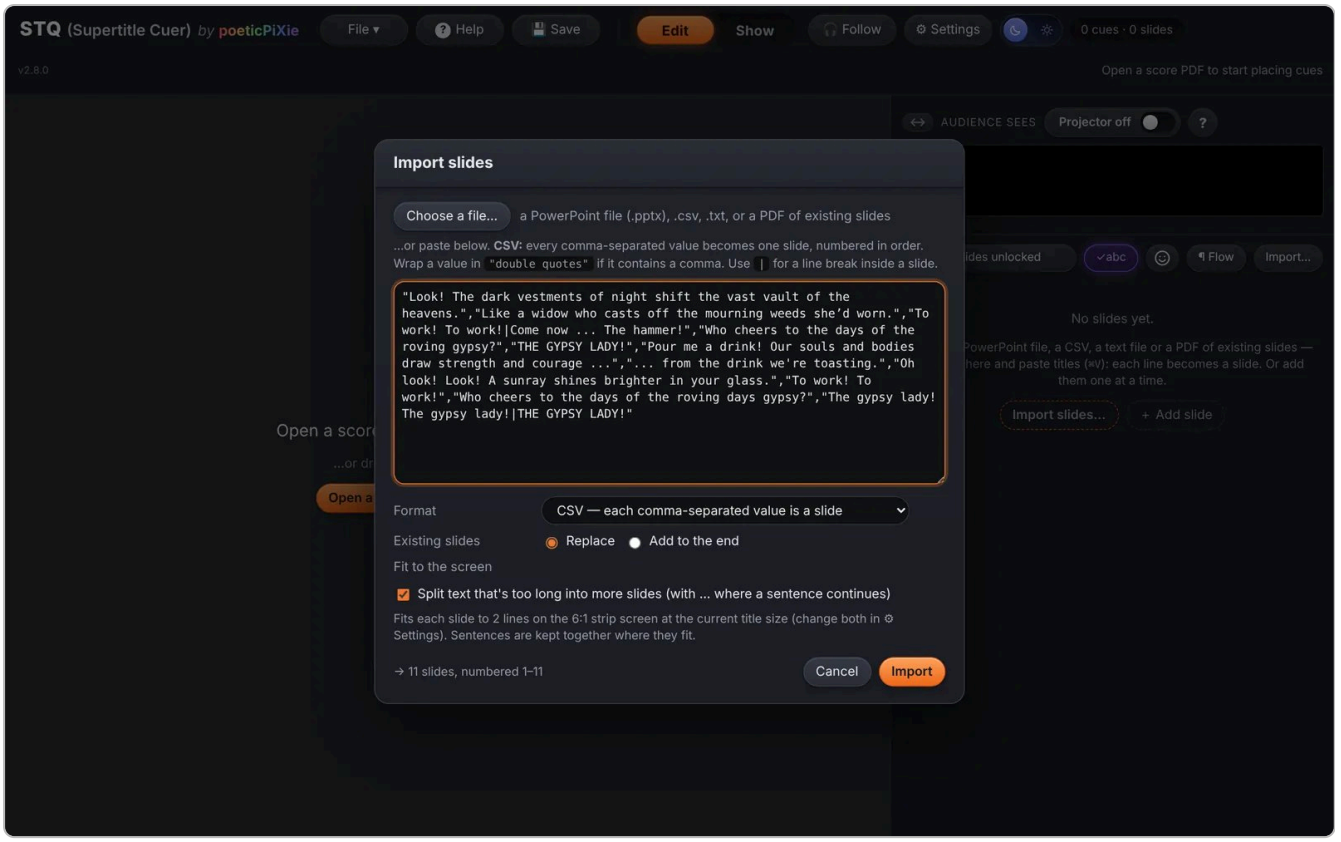
1. Start

Open Supertitle Cuer. The score area on the left is empty; the slides — the titles — will go on the right.

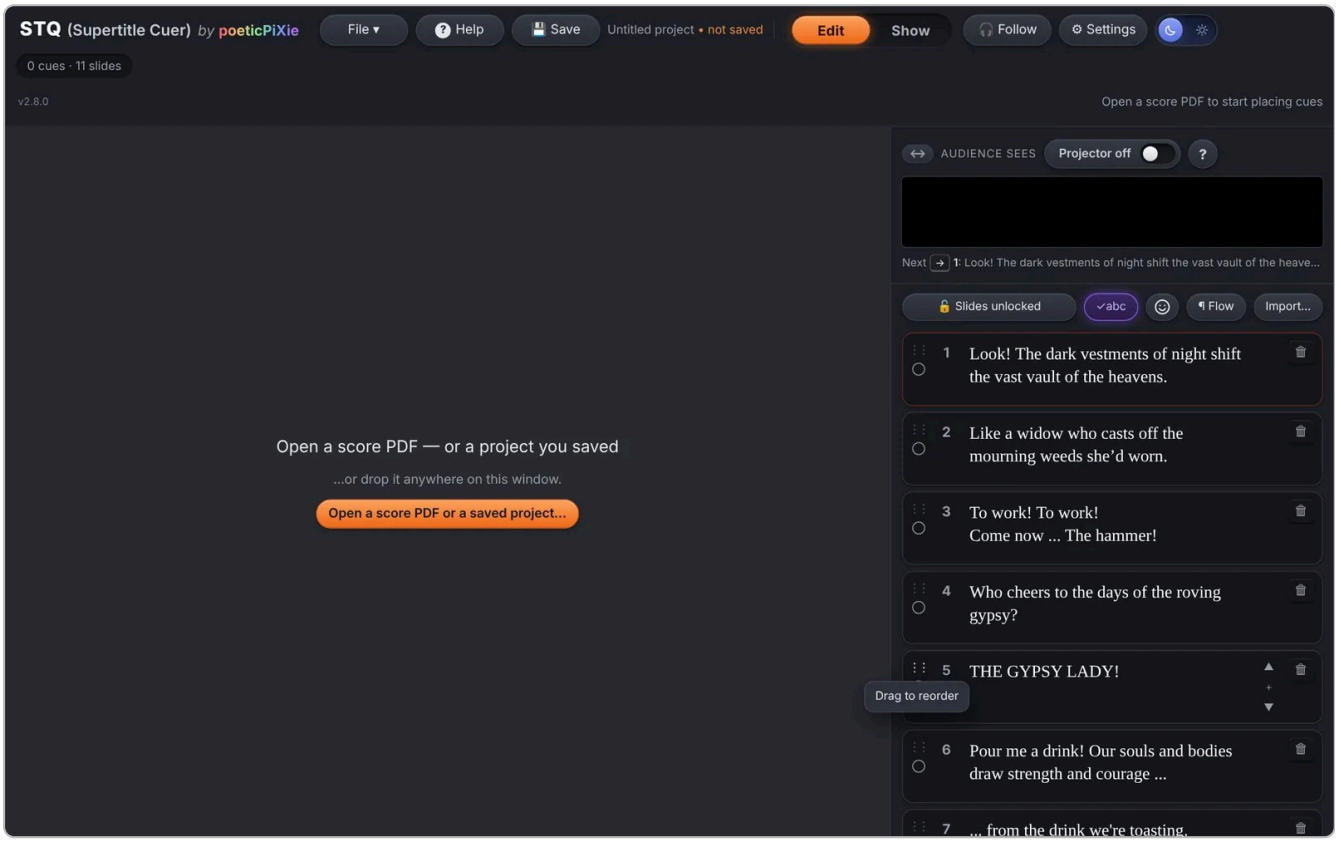


2. Paste in all the titles

Click **Import…** above the slides. Paste the titles into the box, separated by commas (put each one in `"double quotes"` if it contains a comma, and use `|` for a line break inside a title) — or choose a `.csv` or `.txt` file. Click **Import**.



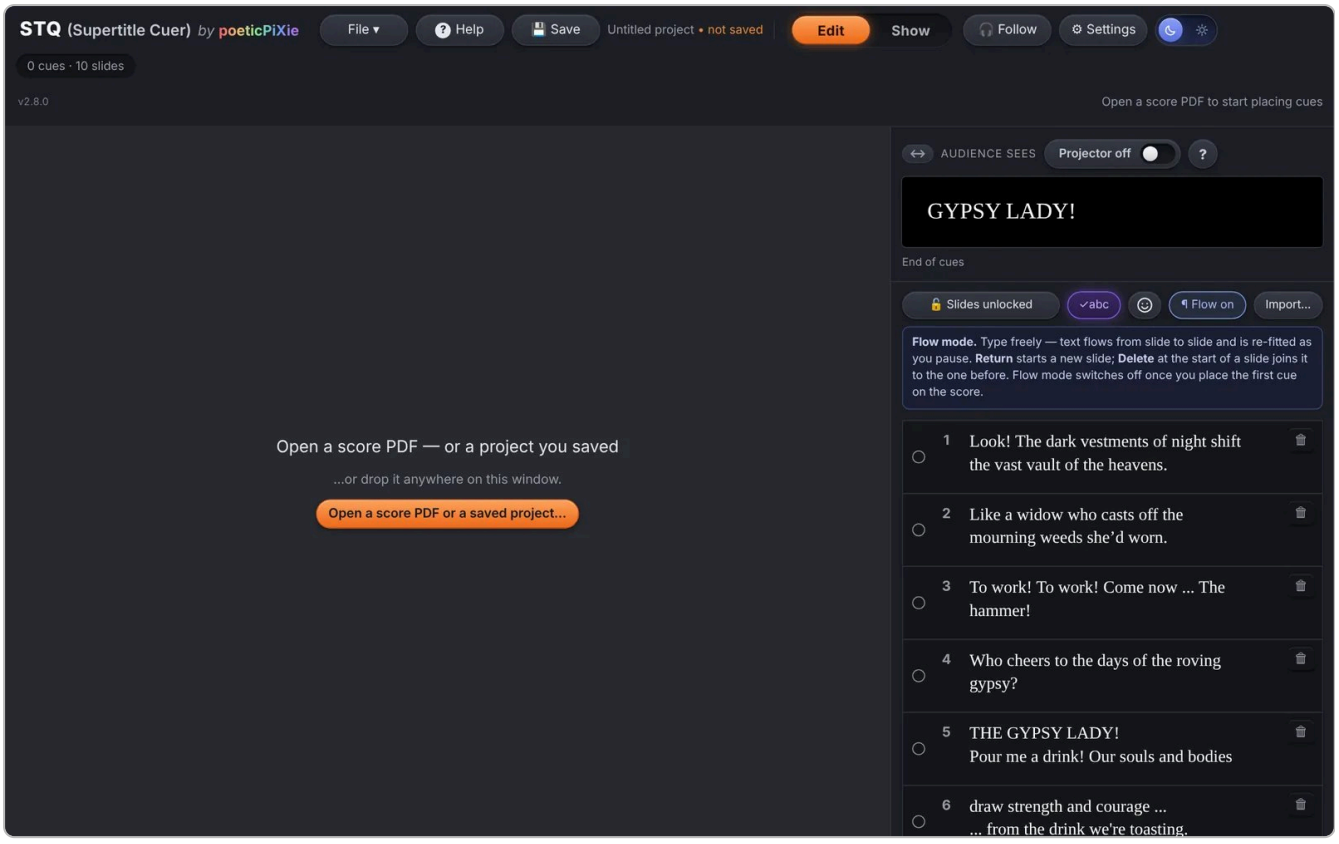
Each title becomes a numbered slide. Titles too long for the screen are split for you (see Bringing in titles).



2b. Or: paste plain text into Flow mode

No commas or quotation marks needed: one title per line (or simply the libretto as it is) works too.

1. Before placing any cues, click **¶ Flow** above the slides.
2. Click **Add slide** (or into the first slide) and paste the text.
3. The paste keeps your line breaks and fills the slides forward from where you pasted. Extra text continues into the following slides; earlier slides stay as they are.



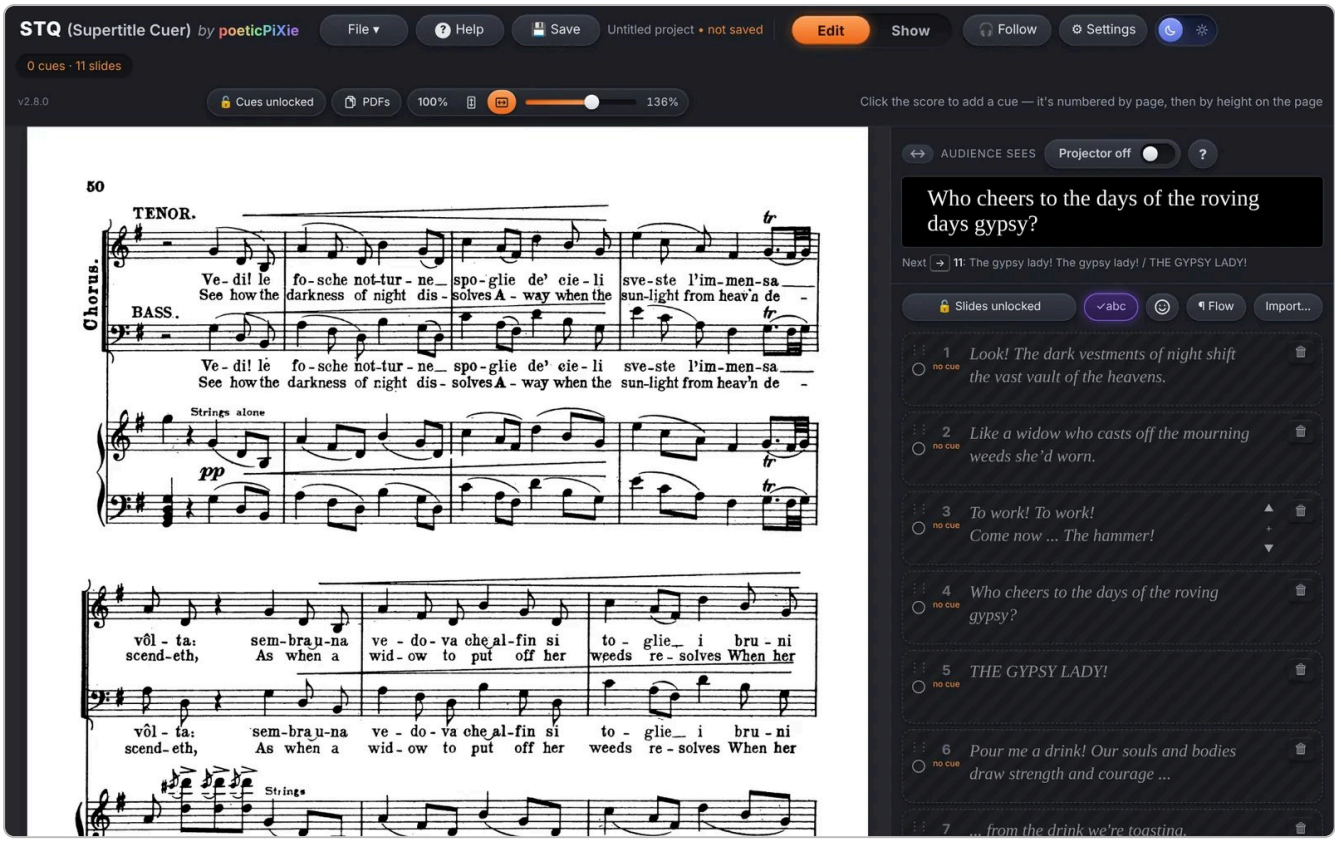
⌨ IN FLOW MODE

`Return`	start a new slide here
`Shift` + `Return`	line break inside a slide
`Delete` at the start	join with the slide before

Flow mode switches off by itself once you place the first cue, so the titles never move afterwards. Plain text also works through **Import…** with **Format: Text** — then every line becomes exactly one slide.

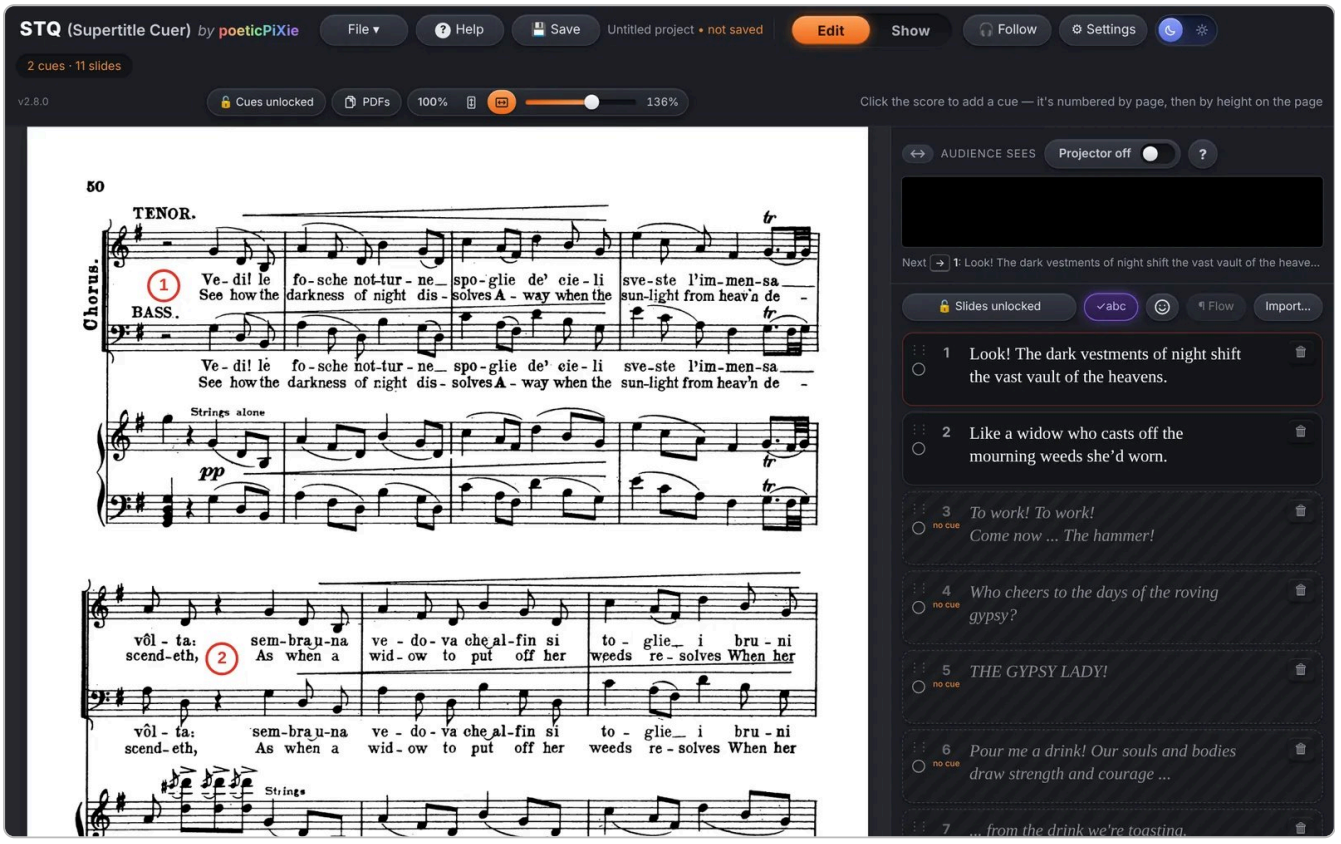
3. Add the score

Click **File** ▾ → **Open…** and choose the score PDF, or drop it onto the window. The slides turn striped and say “no cue” — they are waiting for their cues.



4. Click the cues onto the score

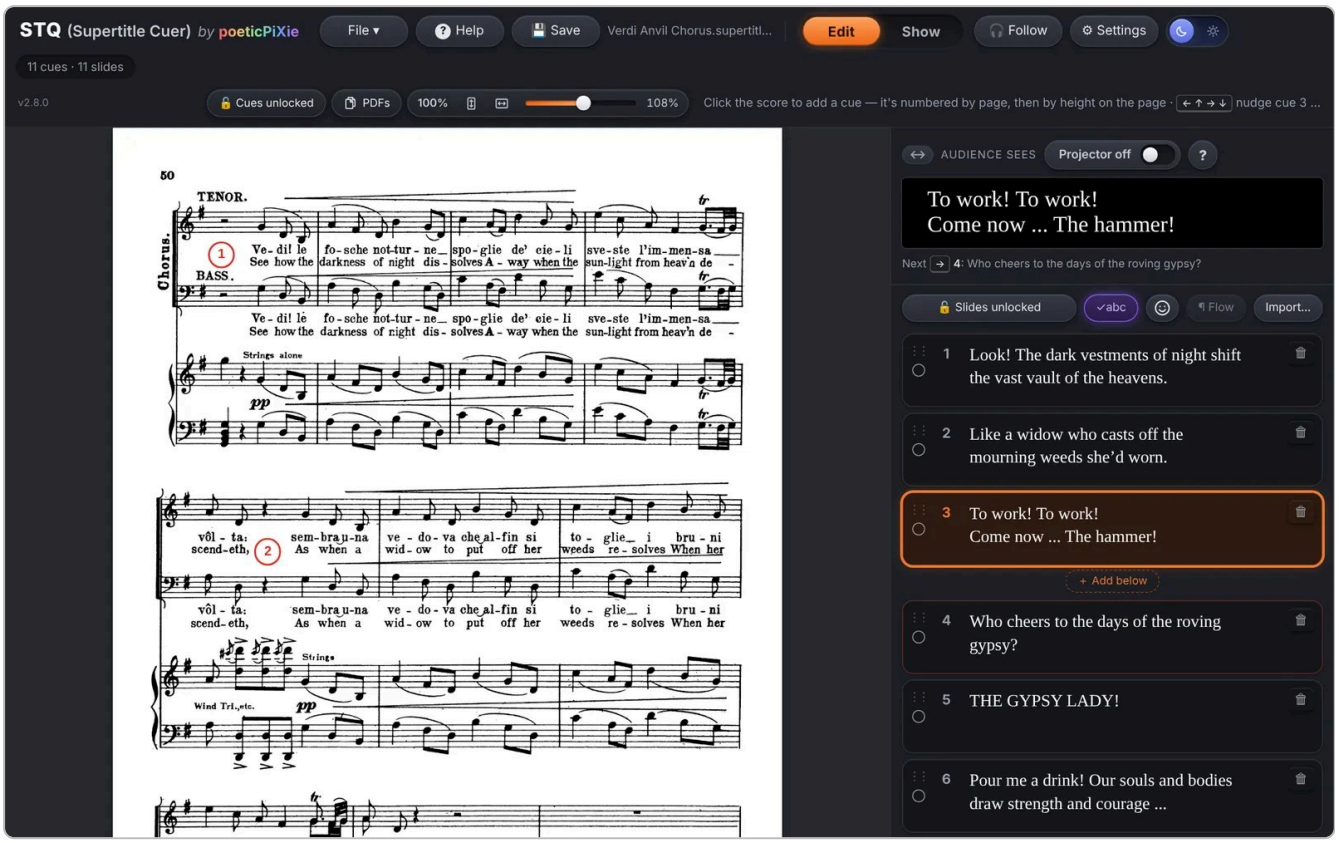
With **Edit** selected, click the score wherever a title should change. Each click adds a numbered red circle, and the slide with the same number is now cued.



⌨ CUES ON THE SCORE (EDIT MODE)

click	add a cue
← ↑ → ↓	nudge the selected cue (`Shift`: bigger steps)
`Delete` or right-click	delete the selected cue
`⌘Z`	undo

Cues are numbered by their place in the score — page, then top to bottom, then left to right — so you can add them in any order. Drag one to move it; right-click one to delete it.

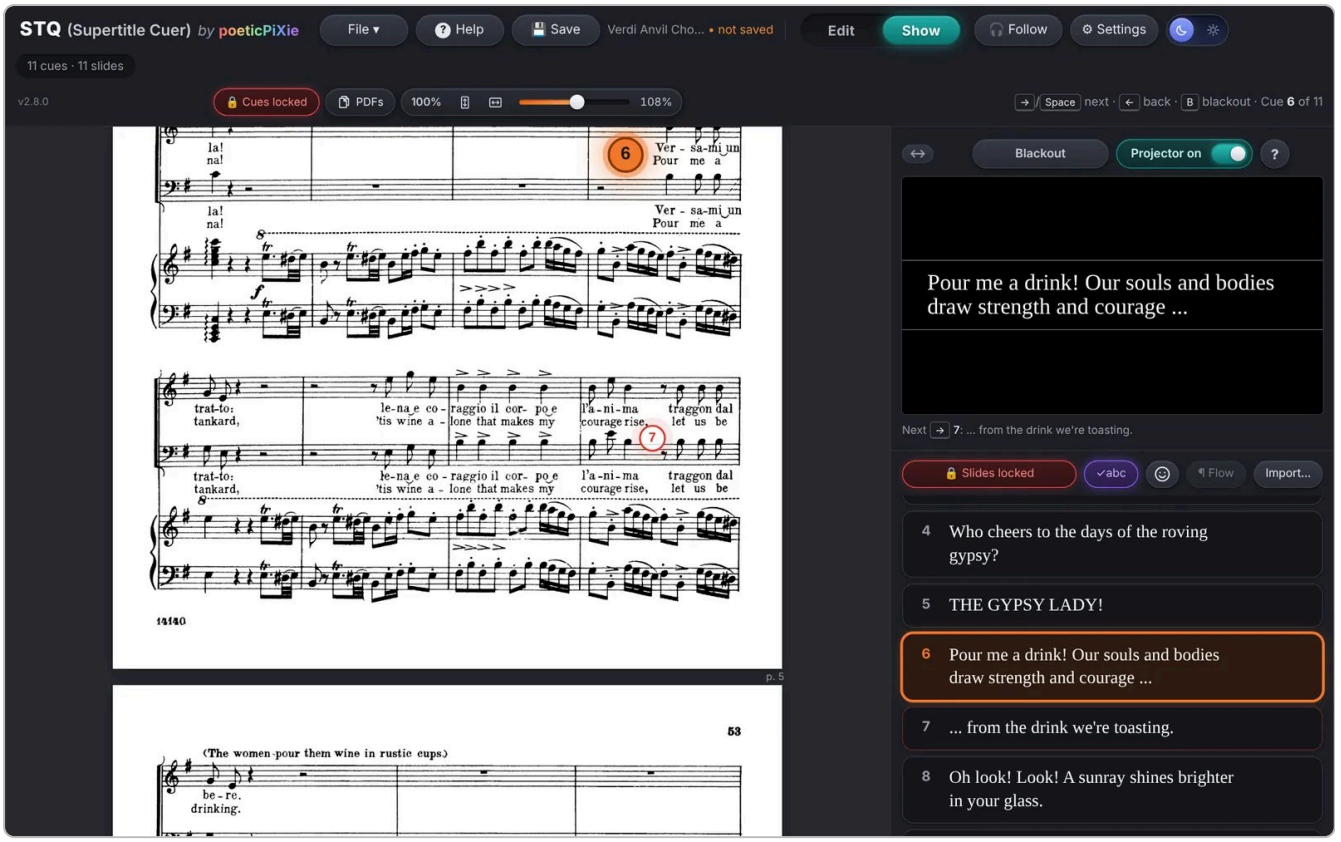


5. Choose the look, and save

Click ⚙ **Settings** and pick the **Screen shape** of your projector (16:9, 4:3 or the 6:1 strip), the font, size and colors; the **Audience sees** preview shows the result. Then press `⌘S`: score, cues, titles and settings are saved in one `.supertitles` file. Want a PDF anyone can open? **File** ▾ → **Save As PDF…** gives the score with every cue numbered and a cue sheet with all your titles at the end.

6. Run the show

Connect the projector as an *extended* screen (see The quickest way to connect your projector) and flip the **Projector** switch (above **Audience sees**) to on. Click **Show** and press `→` or `Space` — or a presentation clicker — for each title. `←` goes back and `B` blanks the screen.



RUNNING THE SHOW (SHOW MODE)

→ Space Page Down	next title
← Page Up	previous title
B	blackout on / off
Home	back to before cue 1

> Want a countdown to every cue? Record a rehearsal with ● **Record** and switch on Follow the music.

How it works (it's simpler than it sounds)

If you can follow a score, you can run supertitles with STQ. Here's the whole idea in one minute.

Supertitle Cuer pairs two things: **cues** — numbered circles you place on the score where each title should change — and **slides** — the titles themselves. Slide 1 goes up at cue 1, slide 2 at cue 2, and so on. During the performance you follow the score, and when the music reaches the next circle you press one key; the projector shows the next title.

Cues are always numbered by where they are in the score, never by the order you placed them: first by page, then from the top of the page down, then left to right along a line of music. Add a cue anywhere and the ones after it renumber by themselves, and the slides move with them.

The whole production — the score (even several PDFs), the cues, the titles, the display settings and any reference recordings — is saved in one `.supertitles` file.

Getting Supertitle Cuer onto your computer

A couple of minutes, once — then it's just there whenever you need it.

Mac

Installing on a Mac takes one line in the **Terminal** app. To open it, press `⌘Space`, type `Terminal` and press `Return`. Then follow the branch that fits you. Not sure if you have Homebrew? Type `brew --version` and press `Return`: a version number means yes, “command not found” means no.

Ⓐ You already have Homebrew

Copy this line into Terminal and press `Return`:

```
brew install --cask poetic-pixie/tap/supertitle-cuer && xattr -dr com.apple.quarant
ine "/Applications/Supertitle Cuer.app"
```

It installs STQ and then clears the macOS quarantine flag, so the app opens straight away.

Ⓑ You don't have Homebrew yet

This one line installs Homebrew, then STQ, then clears the quarantine flag:

```
/bin/bash -c "$(curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Homebrew/install/HEAD/
install.sh)" && eval "$(/opt/homebrew/bin/brew shellenv 2>/dev/null || /usr/local/b
in/brew shellenv)" && brew install --cask poetic-pixie/tap/supertitle-cuer && xattr
-dr com.apple.quarantine "/Applications/Supertitle Cuer.app"
```

It asks for your Mac's password (nothing appears as you type — that's normal) and may take a few minutes the first time. When Homebrew finishes it shows “Next steps”: do them too, so that `brew` also works in new Terminal windows later.

Rather not install Homebrew? Download the `.dmg` from the Releases page of **github.com/Poetic-PiXie/supertitle-cuer** (`arm64` for Apple Silicon Macs — M1 and later — or `x64` for Intel), drag the app to Applications, and run just the last part in Terminal:

```
xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine "/Applications/Supertitle Cuer.app"
```

> Why the `xattr` part? STQ isn't signed with an Apple Developer ID, so macOS blocks it as “damaged” or “can't be opened” until that quarantine flag is removed. Running it when it isn't needed does no harm.

Updating later (Homebrew):

```
brew update && brew upgrade --cask supertitle-cuer
```

Windows

Download `Supertitle_Cuer-Setup-….exe` from the Releases page and run it. If Windows shows “Windows protected your PC”, click **More info** → **Run anyway**.

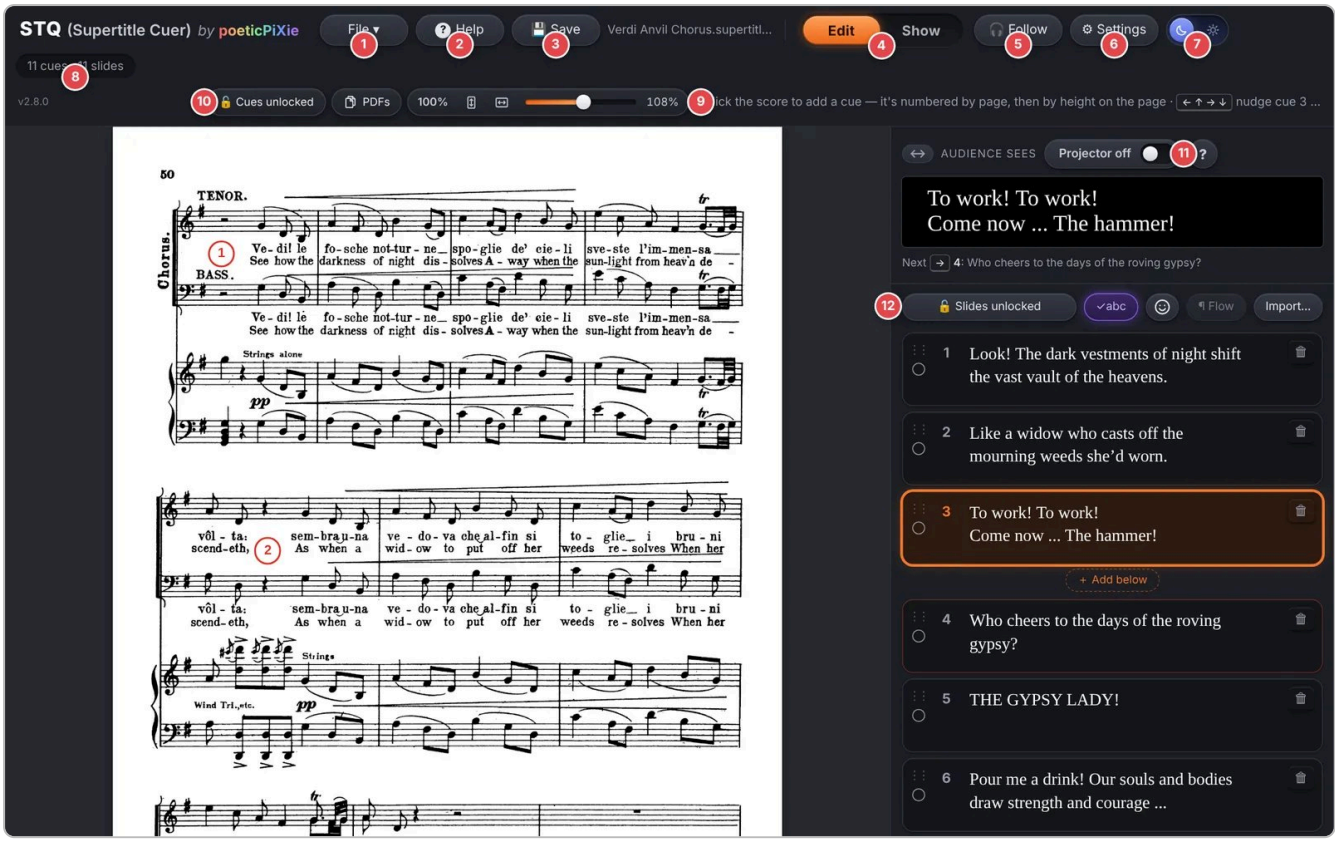
No installation: the single HTML file

`Supertitle_Cuer.html` is the whole app in one file. Double-click it to run it in Google Chrome on any computer; it opens and saves the same `.supertitles` files. The desktop app adds a few things the browser can't do:

- double-clicking a `.supertitles` file opens it;
- the projector window goes full screen on the second screen by itself (in the browser, set **Settings** → **Projector on** to **Screen 2** and press `F` in the projector window);
- the computer and both screens stay awake during Show mode;
- saving needs no browser prompts, and closing asks about unsaved changes;
- spelling suggestions, synonyms and **Look Up** in the right-click menu.

A quick tour of the window

Everything you need sits on one screen: the score on one side, your titles on the other, and the audience's view right above them.



1. **File menu** — new, open, save, export and import (see Saving your work).
2. **? Help** — this guide, searchable.
3. 💾 **Save** and the project's name. "• not saved" means there are unsaved changes.
4. **Edit / Show** — Edit to place cues and write titles, Show to run the performance.
5. 🎧 **Follow** — listen to the music and count down to the next cue. ▶ **Auto** ▾ beside it can advance prepared cues from a recording or live music.
6. ⚙ **Settings** — the look of the titles, the screen shape and cue size.
7. The **Night / Day switch** — dark or light look for the app.
8. How many **cues** are on the score and how many **slides** there are.
9. The **hint line** — what clicking and the keys do right now.
10. The **score controls**, centered over the score: lock the cues, manage PDFs, and the view size (100 %, fit height, fit width, or any size on the slider).
11. **Audience sees** — exactly what is on the projector (or what will be), with the **Projector switch** above it: flip it on to open the audience window. It glows teal and gently breathes while the projector is live.
12. The **slides** (supertitles), with the slides lock, spelling, emoji, flow mode and import.

The ↔ button above the preview swaps the two sides, so the score can be on the right and the slides on the left. Each computer remembers its choice.

⌨ ANYWHERE

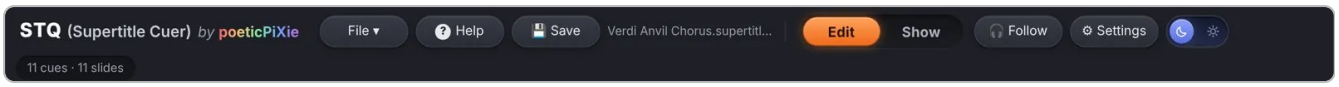
`F1` or `⌘?`	open this Help
`⌘,`	Settings (desktop app)
`⇧⌘E` / `⇧⌘R`	Edit / Show mode (desktop app)

💡 TIPS

- Hover over any button for a moment: a tooltip tells you what it does.
- The hint line under the toolbar changes with what you're doing — glance at it whenever you're not sure what a click or a key will do.
- Prefer the score on the right? Click ↔ once; STQ remembers your choice on this computer.
- On a small laptop screen, zoom the score with **–** / **Fit** / **+** above it; the titles and the preview stay as they are.
- Working on several productions? Each one is its own `.supertitles` file — open, save and switch between them whenever you like.

Everything in the toolbar

A handful of buttons, each with one clear job.



File ▾

New project, Close project, Open, Save, Save As, Save As PDF, Export printable score, Print score, Import slides (PowerPoint, CSV, text or PDF), Export slides as PowerPoint, CSV or text, and two clean-up commands: Remove all cue markers and Remove all slides. In the desktop app the same commands are in the menu bar.

? Help

This guide. Type in its search box to find any topic.

💾 Save

Saves everything into the project file (`⌘S`). The first time, it asks where.

Edit / Show

The two modes — the switch glows **orange** in Edit and **teal** in Show, so you can tell at a glance. In **Edit** a click on the score adds a cue and the slides can be typed in. In **Show** the keyboard runs the titles and nothing can be changed by accident. `⇧⌘E` and `⇧⌘R` switch in the desktop app.

🎧 Follow

Reference recordings and the live countdown. While following it reads 🎧 **Following**; while recording, ● **Recording**.

▶ Auto ▾

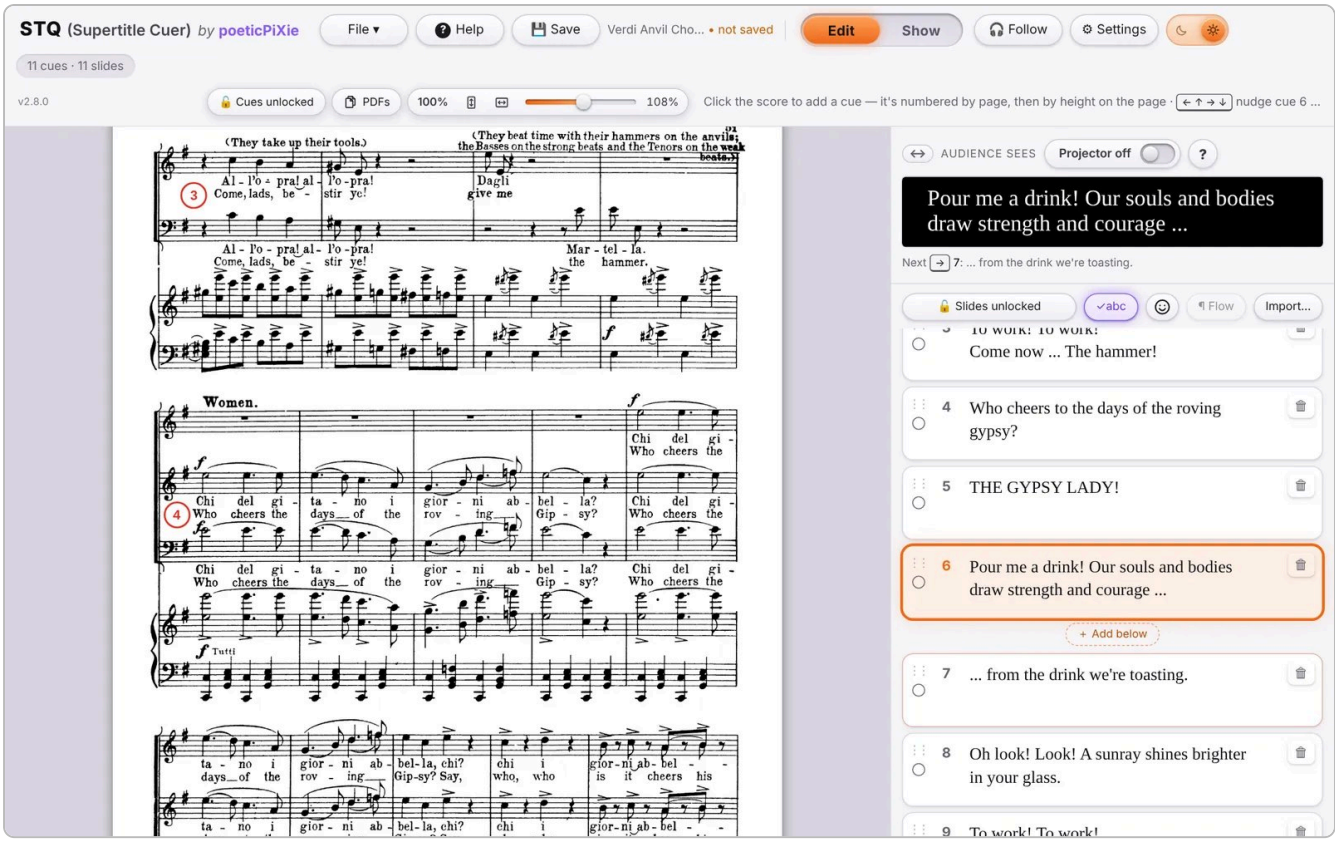
Auto recording… or **Auto live (beta)** advances prepared cues automatically. It is available when the selected PDF section has a reference run and every cue is timed in order. See Follow and Auto.

⚙ Settings

Screen shape, transition, font, style, colors, alignment, text size, vertical position, side margins and cue circle size (see Making the titles look just right).

☾ ☀ Night / Day

The moon-and-sun switch flips the whole app between the **Night** look (dark — kind to your eyes in a dark theatre, the default) and the **Day** look (light, for rehearsal rooms and daylight). It is remembered on this computer and never changes the titles on the projector.



The **Day** look: the same app in light colors, for rehearsal rooms and daylight.

The **Projector switch** lives at the top of the **Audience sees** panel, right above the picture it sends out: **Projector off** / **Projector on**. While it is on it glows teal; switching it off during Show mode asks first.

Under the toolbar, the **hint line** always says what a click or a key will do at this moment — for example which cue the arrow keys would nudge, or the Show-mode keys and the current cue number.

Cues: one click on the score

This is the heart of it. Click where a title should change — that's a cue. STQ numbers and orders them for you, so you never have to.

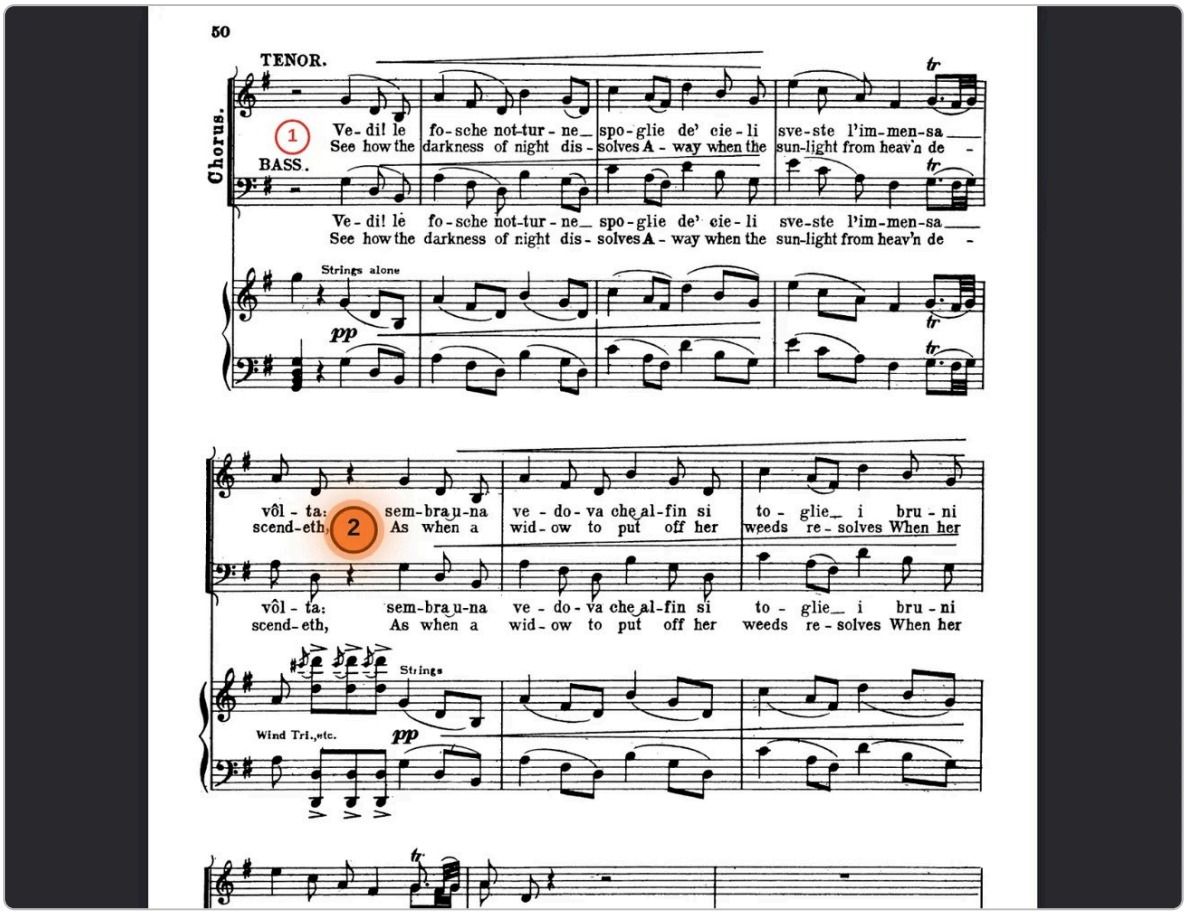
Opening a score

Open a PDF with **File** ▾ → **Open…**, by dropping it on the window, or with the button in the empty score area. A score opened into an existing project replaces the old score but keeps the slides. Several PDFs (for example one per act) can be combined — see Several PDFs.

The view buttons above the score set the page size: **100%** shows it at actual size, the next button fits the whole page height in the panel, the third fits the page width. The slider beside them picks any size from 25 % to 400 %, and the number shows the current size.

VIEW SIZE

⌘0	actual size (100 %)
⌘1	fit the page height — a whole page at a glance
⌘2	fit the page width



The orange cue is the current one; in Show mode the next one pulses. A dashed circle would mean a cue that has no slide yet.

Placing cues

In Edit mode, click the score where a title should appear. The new cue gets a blue ring, and the hint line says which number it got. If it lands before existing cues, they renumber and a message says so.

How cues are numbered

By page first, then by rows from the top, then left to right. Two cues count as being on the same row unless one is clearly higher: its center has to be at least 1.5 × the circle's radius above the other's. So a cue placed slightly higher at the end of a line still comes after the cues to its left.

Selecting, moving and deleting

- **Select** a cue by clicking it. Its slide is selected too, and the projector (if open) shows that title.
- **Move** it by dragging, or nudge it with the arrow keys: 5 pixels per press, 25 with `Shift`. A burst of nudges is one undo step. If the new place changes its number, a message says so.
- **Delete** it with a right-click, or select it and press `Delete`. Deleting a cue never deletes a slide: the slides keep their order, so from there on each slide pairs with the next remaining cue.
- **Deselect** (in Edit mode) by clicking any empty space outside the score pages and slides, or with `Esc`.

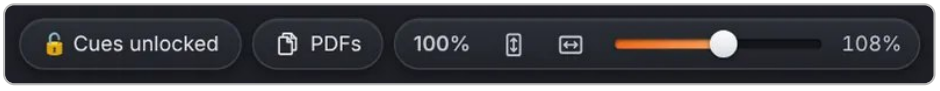
⌨ CUES

`←` `↑` `→` `↓`	nudge the selected cue 5 px — Edit mode, cues unlocked, after clicking the score
`Shift` + arrows	nudge 25 px
`←` `→`	previous / next cue — in Show mode, or while the cues are locked
`Delete`	delete the selected cue
`Esc`	deselect

Locking the cues

The score's own controls sit in the top bar, centered over the score (they move with it when you swap sides). 🔓 **Cues unlocked** (gray, like the other buttons) turns into a red 🔒 **Cues locked** with a click. When locked, clicking the score only selects cues, and nothing can add, move or delete them by accident.

🔒 **Show locks, Edit unlocks.** Switching to **Show** locks both the cues and the slides, so nothing can change during the performance; switching back to **Edit** unlocks them both. You can still flip either lock by hand at any time — that never changes the mode. Opening a saved project also locks both.



Cue circle size

⚙ **Settings** → **Cue circle size** (2 to 6, default 4) changes how big the circles are, on screen and in the printable score.

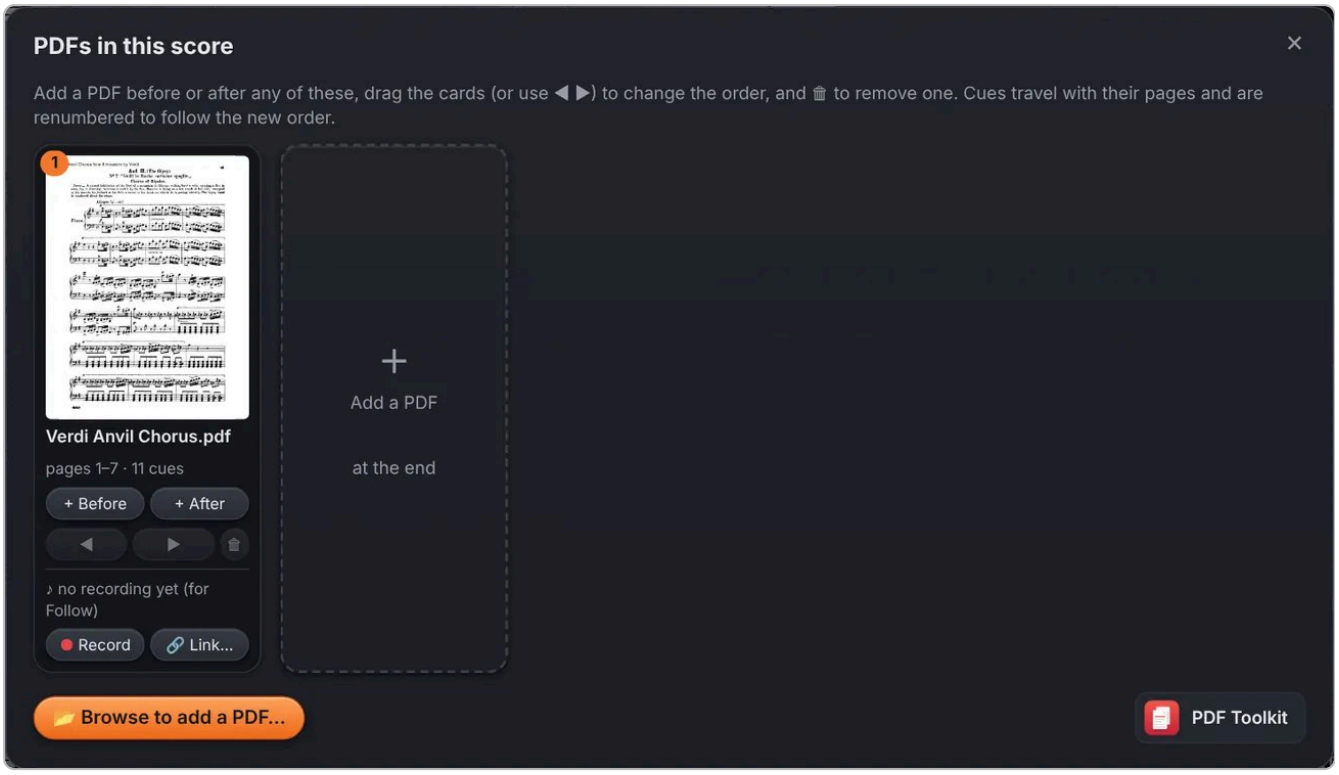
💡 **TIPS FOR PLACING CUES**

- Put each cue on the note or syllable where the title should *appear* — usually a beat before the singer starts the line, so the audience reads as they hear.
- Repeated text? Give each repeat its own cue and its own title (even if the words are the same), so the count never drifts during the show.
- Long instrumental passages need no cue: the last title stays up, or add a blank slide to clear the screen.
- Work through the score page by page with the piano reduction open, or listen along with a recording — cues placed while hearing the music land best.
- When the cues are right, lock them. The red 🔒 **Cues locked** button makes stray clicks harmless, and Show mode locks them for you anyway.
- Need it on paper? See one score PDF with every cue numbered.

Several acts? Several PDFs — no problem

Keep each act, number or insert as its own PDF and put them in order like cards on a table. Your cues and titles follow along.

A score can be made of several PDFs — Act 1, Act 2, an inserted aria. Click **PDFs** above the score to see them as cards.

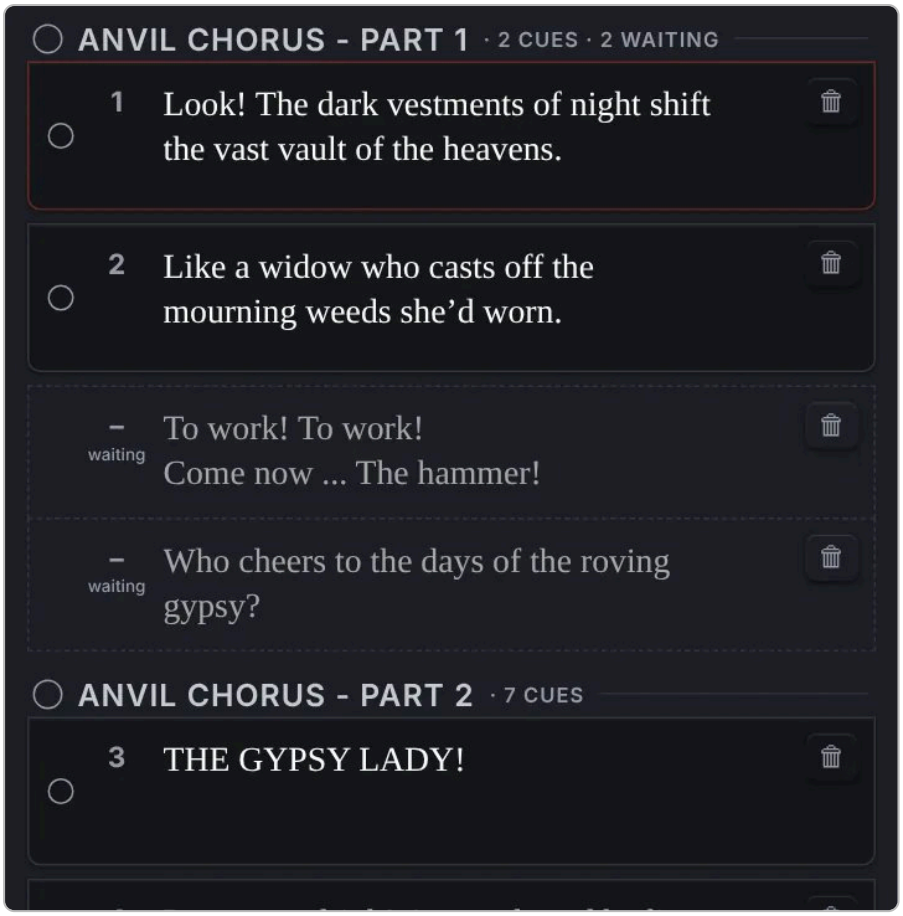


- **Add** a PDF before or after any card with **+ Before** / **+ After**, at the end with the last card, or with **Browse to add a PDF…**.
- **Reorder** by dragging the cards, or with ◀ ▶. Each PDF's cues travel with their pages and are renumbered, and their supertitles move with them so every title stays with its cue.
- **Remove** a PDF with 🗑. Its cues go with it; a question asks whether to delete its supertitles too (unticked: they move to **Not cued yet** at the end of the list). The other PDFs keep theirs.
- While cues are locked, PDFs can't be added, moved or removed (that would renumber cues); the panel offers 🔒 **Unlock to make changes**.
- Each card also has ● **Record** and 🔗 **Link…** for that PDF's reference recording, and shows how many of its cues are timed.

The PDFs are merged into one score inside the project; Undo brings back a removed or moved PDF.

Each PDF has its own supertitles

Each score PDF has a section heading in the slide list. With two or more PDFs, the list is divided into those sections, each with its title and number of cues. A PDF's cues take the lines in its section, in order, so **adding or removing a cue in one PDF never shifts the supertitles of another**.



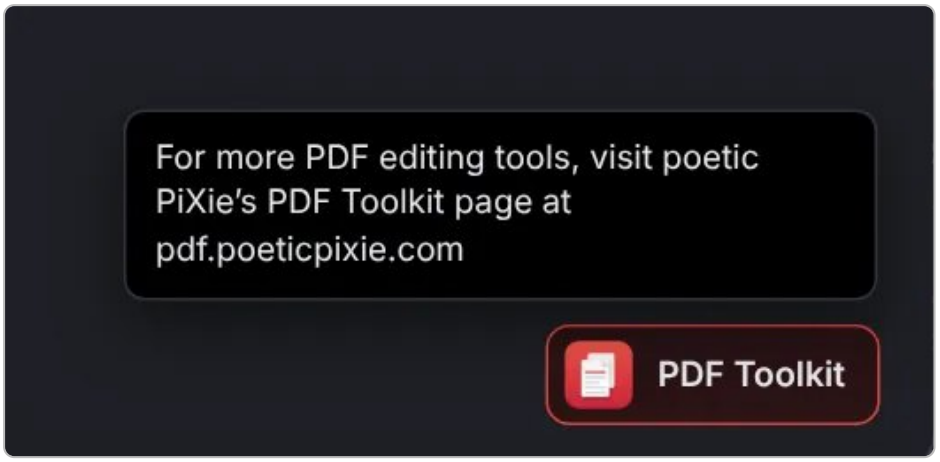
Part 1 has two lines waiting for a cue. Part 2's cues keep their own supertitles.

- **Section actions.** Click or right-click the section heading. The first choices, **Auto recording…** and **Auto live (beta)**, launch that section even when another cue is selected; they are disabled until the section is prepared. The menu also offers **Rename section…**, **Copy all slides** and **Copy all slides + associated PDF**. The last choice includes its score pages and cue links. Copying is available with slides locked, including in Show mode.
- **Rename a section.** In Edit mode with slides unlocked, choose **Rename section…** or double-click the heading, type the new title and press `Return` (or click elsewhere). `Esc` cancels. Clearing the title brings back the PDF's name. The new title is saved in the project and appears in the PDFs and Follow panels; the original PDF filename stays the same.
- **Lines waiting for a cue.** If a PDF's section has more lines than the PDF has cues, the extra ones wait at the end of its section, grayed and marked *waiting*. The next cue you place in that PDF takes the first of them. If a PDF has more cues than lines, its last cues get blank supertitles until you type them.
- **Link to PDF.** To give lines to a PDF, select them (shift-click a supertitle; shift-click another to select a range) and click 🔗 **Link to PDF…** in the bar above the list. It asks *Link to the current PDF?*, suggesting the PDF on screen in the score; choose another from the menu if needed. The lines join the end of that PDF's section.
- **Not cued yet.** Lines after the last PDF's section belong to no PDF yet. Placing cues in the last PDF takes them in order, just as with a single PDF, so the usual way of working (type or import all the titles, then click the cues) still works. Use ↩ on a waiting line to send it back here.
- Use **Add above** or **Add below** beside the selected slide to insert a line in that slide's section. A line moved with ▲ ▼ or by dragging joins the section it lands in.

- **Section color.** Click the ring before a PDF's name to pick a color for the whole section: all its supertitles and its cues on the score take it, including ones you add later. A supertitle's own color ring still wins; its ring shows the section color as an outline until you give it a color of its own, and **Same as its PDF** in its palette goes back to the section color.
- **End of section.** The final cued slide of each PDF shows a red **Last Slide for this Section** label in the operator's preview. It stays off the audience screen and does not advance or blank the titles. Lines still waiting for cues do not count as extra cued slides.

Preparing PDFs with the PDF Toolkit

Scores rarely arrive exactly as you need them: the whole opera in one file when you only need Act 2, pages scanned sideways, an aria cut from the edition, or an insert from a different score. Supertitle Cuer adds and orders whole PDFs; the **PDF Toolkit**, poetic PiXie's free companion, prepares them first.



Click **PDF Toolkit** at the bottom right of the **PDFs** panel. It opens **pdf.poeticpixie.com** in your browser; everything happens on your own computer, and your files are never uploaded. The tools that matter for a score:

Extract pages
: Keep only the pages you need — one act, one number — as a new PDF.

Split PDF
: Cut a complete score into several files, for example one per act, so each act can be its own PDF here (with its own reference recording for Follow).

Delete pages
: Take out blank pages, title pages or numbers that are cut in your production, so the score matches what is performed.

Rotate pages
: Turn pages that were scanned sideways or upside down.

Merge several PDF files
: Join files into one, when you'd rather manage one PDF than many.

Combine images into a PDF
: Turn photos or scans of score pages (JPEG, PNG) into a PDF that Supertitle Cuer can open.

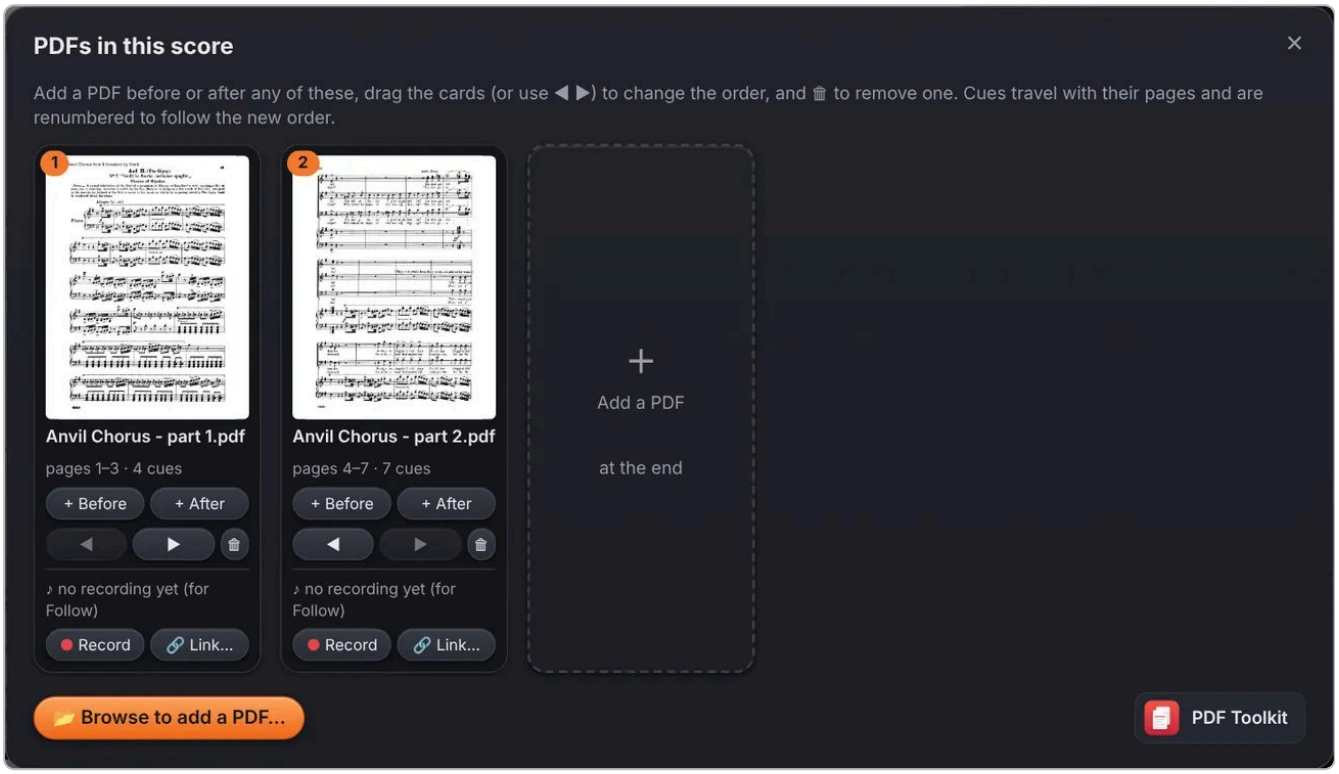
Save the result, then add it with **+ Before**, **+ After** or **Browse to add a PDF…**. Do the trimming *before* you place cues on those pages: removing pages from a PDF that is already in the project means removing and re-adding the whole PDF, and its cues go with it.

All you need is one score PDF with every cue numbered? Easy!

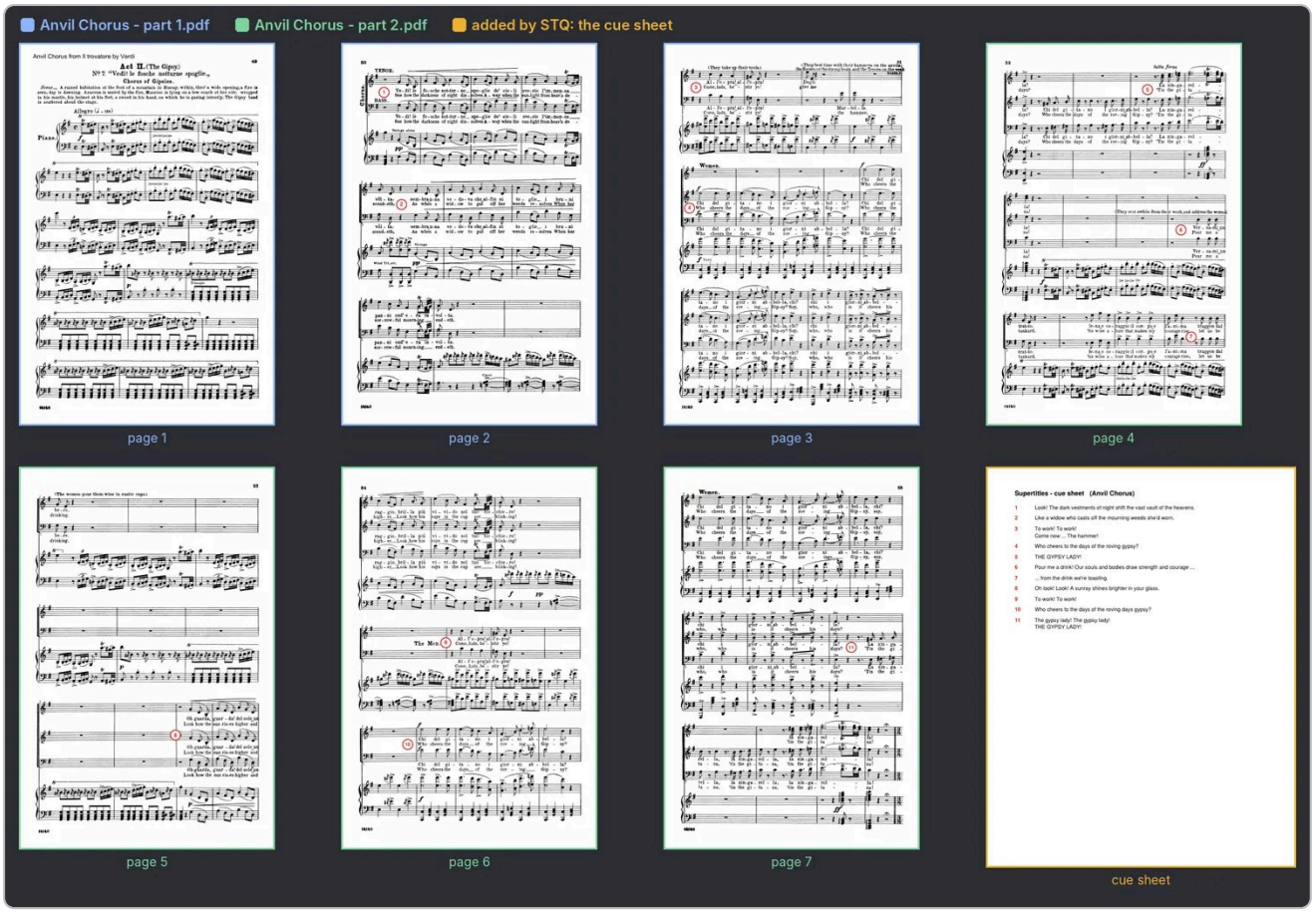
No projector today — just a marked-up score for the stage manager, the conductor or the second operator? STQ rolls all your PDFs into one and numbers every cue for you, in order, from the first page to the last.

Here's a real example: the Anvil Chorus arrived as two separate PDFs, `Anvil Chorus – part 1.pdf` and `Anvil Chorus – part 2.pdf`. The stage manager wants a single printout with the cues on it.

1. **Open the first PDF** — drop it on the window, or **File** ▾ → **Open…**.
2. **Add the others** — click **PDFs** over the score, then **+ After** on the last card (or **Add a PDF at the end**). Drag the cards if the order needs fixing. As far as the cues are concerned, it is now one long score.
3. **Click the cues onto the score**, anywhere and in any order. STQ numbers them for you — by page, then from top to bottom — straight across all the PDFs: if part 1 ends with cue 5, part 2 starts with cue 6. Add a cue in the middle later, and everything after it renumbers itself.
4. **Save it** with **File** ▾ → **Save As PDF…** so you can always come back and edit the cues, then **export it** — **File** ▾ → **Export printable score (PDF)…** (`⌘E` in the desktop app), or print it straight away with `⌘P`. Out comes **one** PDF: every page of every part, in your order, with the red numbered cues drawn on them.



Two PDFs, one score: the cards show which pages and how many cues each part brings.



The exported file: the pages of part 1 and part 2 rolled into one PDF, numbered cues on every page, and the cue sheet added at the end.

The cue sheet comes free. Once the project has titles, the PDF ends with a cue sheet listing every title next to its number (more in Sharing and printing). No titles yet? Then it is simply the combined score with its numbered cues.

💾 **Want to change the cues later? Save it the right way.** Use **File** ▾ → **Save As PDF…** (or plain **Save**). That PDF looks exactly the same in any viewer — combined score, numbered cues, cue sheet at the end — but it also carries the whole project inside. Open it again in STQ and everything comes back to life: move, add or delete cues, edit the titles, and save again.

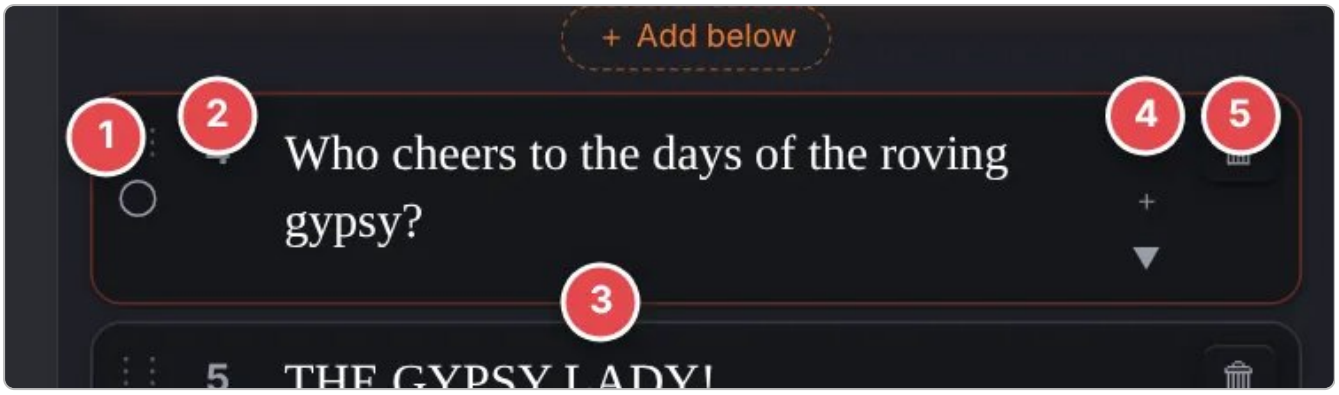
The **Export printable score** file is a picture of the cues for printing and reading only. Opened in STQ it is just a plain score — its cues can't be edited — so keep your Save-As-PDF (or `.supertitles`) file as the one you work on.

💡 **TIPS**

- The cue circles print at the **Cue circle size** set in Settings. A little bigger (5 or 6) reads well on paper from a music stand.
- Rehearsal changed a cue? Move it, export again — the numbers and the cue sheet are always up to date.
- Print double-sided and the cue sheet ends up on its own last pages, easy to pull out and keep on the desk.

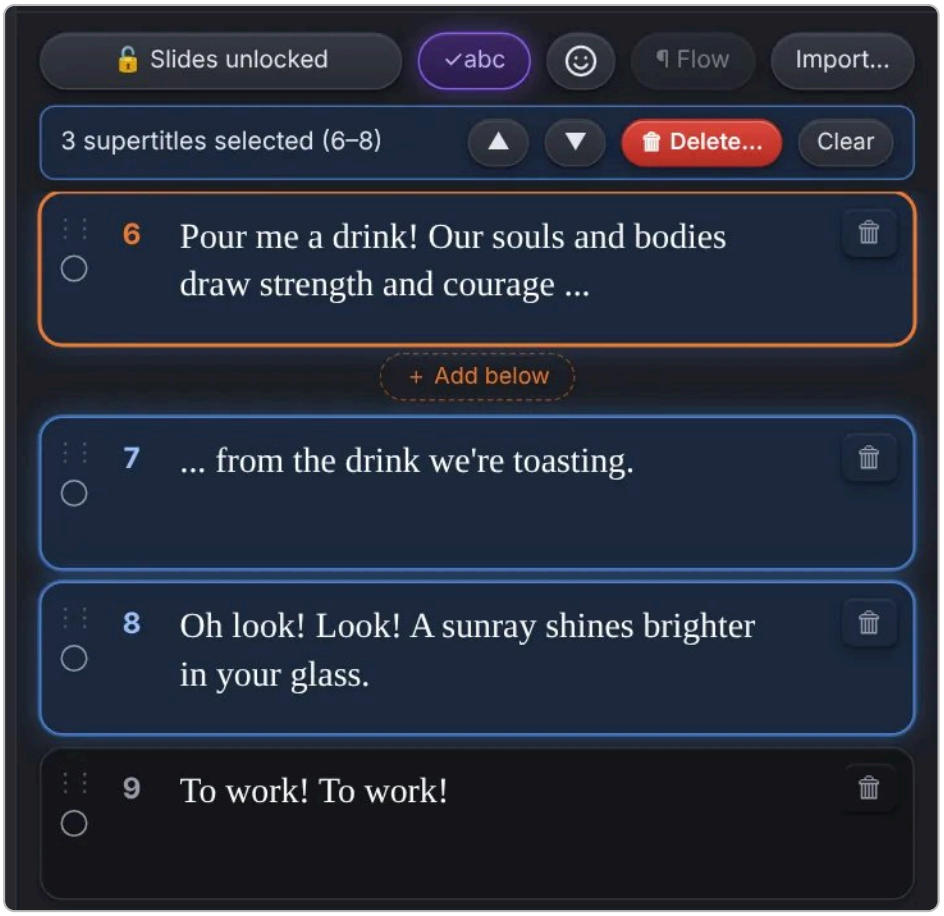
Writing and polishing your titles

Your titles live on the right, one card per title. Typing, reordering and fixing them is as easy as in any notes app.



1. **Grip** — drag to move the slide.
2. **Number** — the cue it belongs to. Click it to show this slide.
3. **Text** — click and type. `Return` starts a new line within the slide.
4. ▲ ▼ — move up, insert an empty slide after it, move down.
5. 🗑 — delete the slide.

- **Add** slides with **Add slide** at the end of the list, on a card, or **Add above** / **Add below** beside the selected slide.
- **Delete** with 🗑. It asks first, and offers to delete the slide's cue too (unticked by default).
- **Select** a slide by clicking it; the projector and the score follow. After clicking in the list, `↑` `↓` step through the slides. While typing, `↑` on a slide's first line and `↓` on its last line carry on into the neighboring slide.
- **Several at once:** click one slide, then `Shift`-click another to select the range. ▲ / ▼ (on a selected card or in the selection bar) or dragging one of them moves the whole block; 🗑 **Delete…** deletes them together. **Copy slides** or `⌘C` copies the range for reuse. Any other click ends the selection.



- **Lock the slides** with 🔓 **Slides unlocked** above the list. While it is red and reads 🔒 **Slides locked**, nothing can change by accident: no typing, no moving, adding, deleting or importing. You can still look through them: click a slide to see its text in **Audience sees**, and use `↑` `↓` to step through the list. Click the button again to unlock.

Copy slides into another project

1. Click the first slide's number, then `Shift`-click the last slide in the range. Press `⌘C` (`Ctrl+C` on Windows), or click **Copy slides** in the selection bar.
2. Open the destination project and unlock its slides in Edit mode. Click the number of the slide that should come immediately before the copied block.
3. Press `⌘V` (`Ctrl+V` on Windows), or click **Paste slides** beside the selected slide. The copies are inserted after it, in their original order.

The copies keep their slide tags, cue colors and source text/background colors. The destination project's font, screen shape and text size control the line wrapping. Each copied slide stays one slide: text that exceeds the destination's limit is grayed out in the list, just as for other long slides; copying does not split it automatically. When you select text inside a slide instead, the usual text-copy and text-paste shortcuts still apply.

To copy an entire PDF section, use its heading menu's **Copy all slides**. This includes the lines waiting for a cue; in a single-PDF project, it also includes the uncued titles at the end. Slide-only copies go after the selected destination slide in its PDF's section. Without a selected cue, they go into the uncued end of the list; **Paste slides** at the end of the list is another way to put them there.

Choose **Copy all slides + associated PDF** when the destination also needs the section's score pages and cue links. Select a cue in the destination section, then paste: STQ adds a new PDF section immediately after that section, with its title, section color, score pages, cues, linked titles and waiting lines. Without a selected cue, the copied section goes at the end. Reference recordings and rehearsal cue timings are not copied, so set up Follow separately for the new production.

SLIDES	
↑ ↓	previous / next slide — after clicking in the slide list
↑ on the first line, ↓ on the last	while typing: carry on into the neighboring slide
`Shift`-click	select a range of slides
`Delete`	delete the selected range (asks first)
`Esc`	stop typing / clear the selection
right-click a word	spelling suggestions, synonyms



What you see is what the audience gets

Each slide box breaks its lines exactly where the screen will: it uses the same font, style and screen shape as the titles, scaled to fit the box. So if a line ends after “roving” in the box, it ends after “roving” on the projector too. Change the font, text size, side margins or screen shape in Settings, and the boxes re-flow at once.

What the colors mean

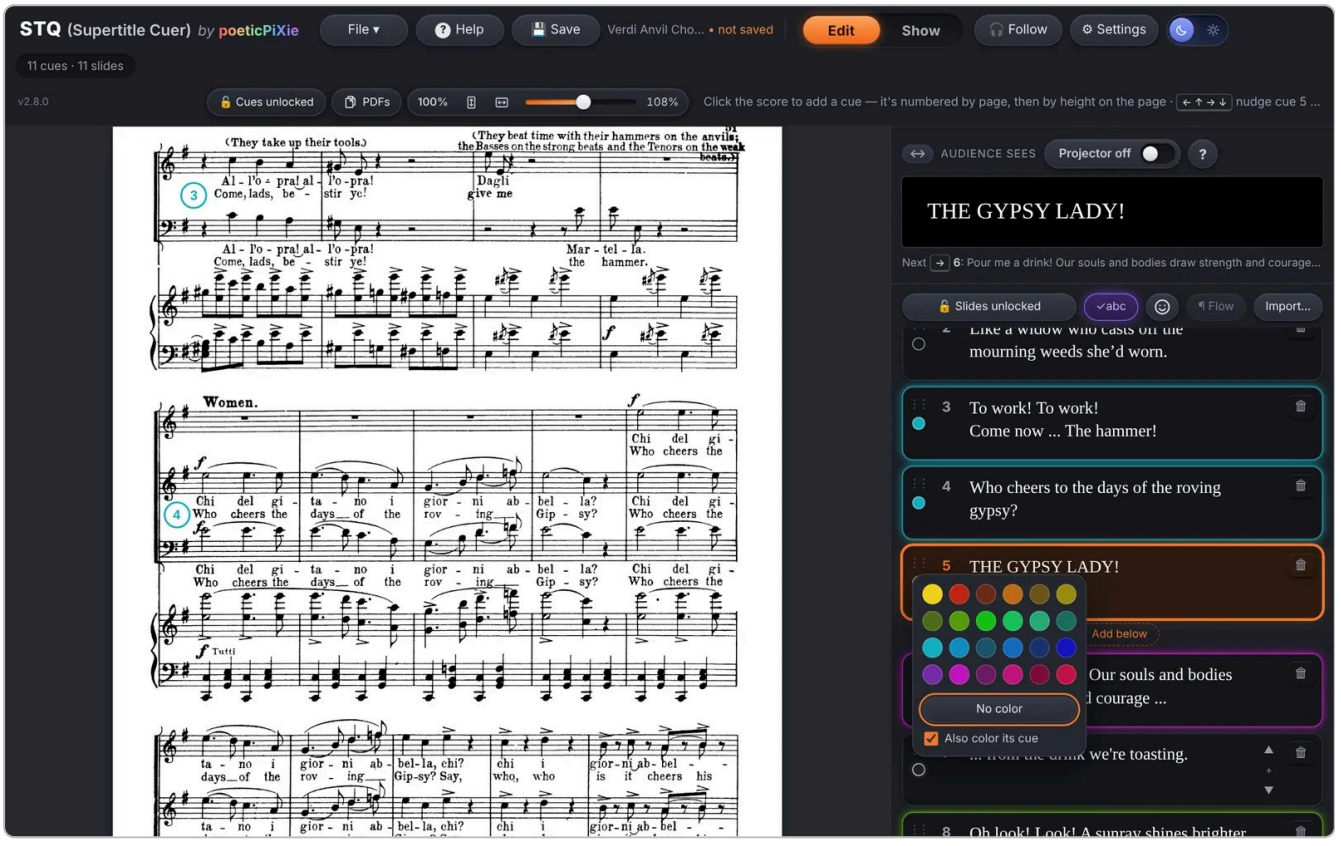
- **Orange border** — the current slide (on the projector).
- **Red, with “too long for the screen”** — the text needs more lines than the screen has (2 on the 6:1 strip, 6 on 16:9 and 4:3). The words that won't fit are grayed out; the projector shows only what fits. Shorten the text or split it.
- **Striped, “no cue”** — there are more slides than cues; place a cue on the score for it.

Color-coding slides and cues

Every slide has a small ring at its left edge, just below the grip. Click it for a palette of 24 colors and pick one: the slide gets a soft glow of that color in the list — one color per character, per scene, or for the passages that still need work. **No color** clears it.

With **Also color its cue** ticked in the palette (it is, until you untick it — STQ remembers your choice), the slide's cue on the score turns the same color too, so you can see at a glance which titles and cues belong together. Untick it to color only the slide. The color always comes from the slide, so it shows the link: move the slide to a new place and the color goes with it, to the cue that now pairs with it; clear the slide's color and its cue goes back to the general **Cue color** from Settings.

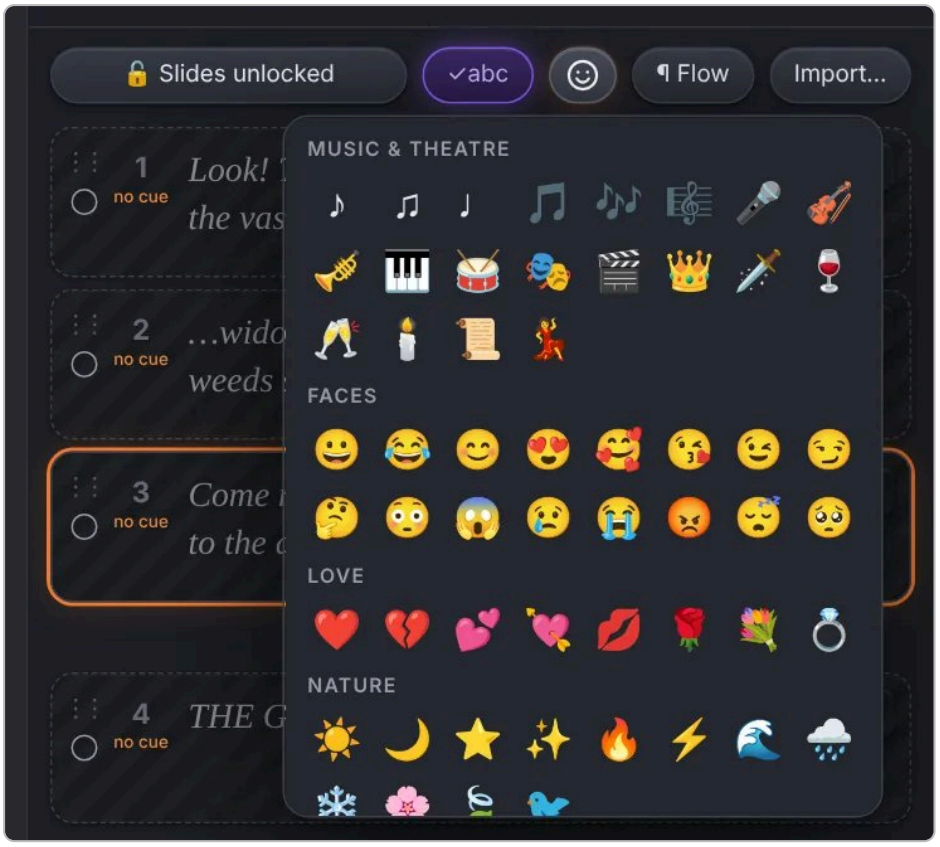
Slide colors are for you only: the projector, the preview and the audience never see them. They are saved with the project. The rings show only while the slides are unlocked in Edit mode; locking the slides (or switching to Show) hides them, and the colors stay.



Color rings on the slides: each colored slide glows in the list and, with “Also color its cue” ticked, its cue on the score takes the same color.

Emoji and music signs

The smiley button above the slides opens a small palette: music signs (♪ ♫, drawn in the title font), music and theatre, faces, love, nature, hands and symbols. Click in a slide where the emoji should go, then pick it; the palette stays open so you can add more, and closes when you click elsewhere or press `Esc`. With no slide being typed in, the emoji goes at the end of the current slide. In the desktop app, **More emoji…** at the bottom opens your computer's full emoji panel (also `Ctrl`+`⌘`+`Space` on a Mac, `⊞`+`.` on Windows).



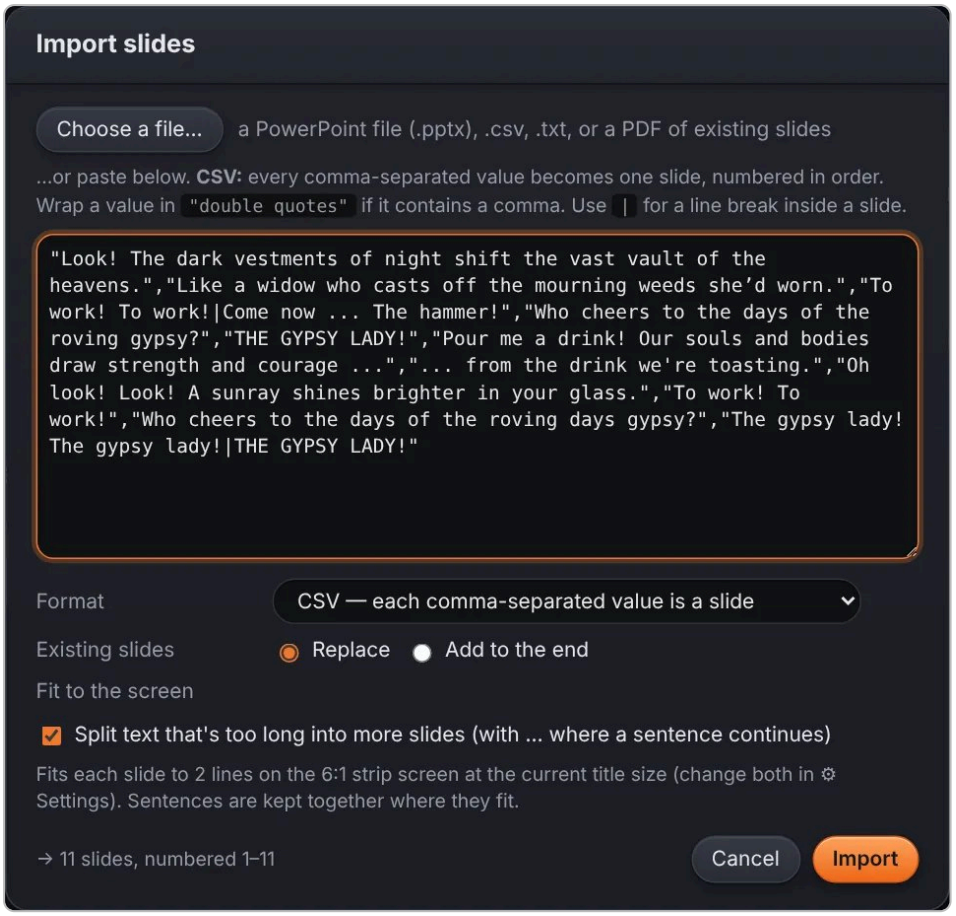
Spelling and synonyms

Misspelled words get a red underline while you edit. Right-click one for suggested corrections, **Learn** (add it to your dictionary) or **Ignore Spelling**. In the desktop app, right-clicking a selected word also offers English **Synonyms**, and on a Mac **Look Up** opens the system dictionary and thesaurus. **✓abc** above the slides (or **Edit** → **Check Spelling While Typing**) switches checking off and on; while it is on, the button glows purple. On Windows, choose the language in **Settings** → **Spelling language**; a Mac uses its own languages.

Bringing in titles you already have

Already have the translation in a document or spreadsheet? Bring it all in at once — no retyping.

Click **Import…** above the slides (or **File** ▾ → **Import slides (PowerPoint / CSV / text / PDF)…**).

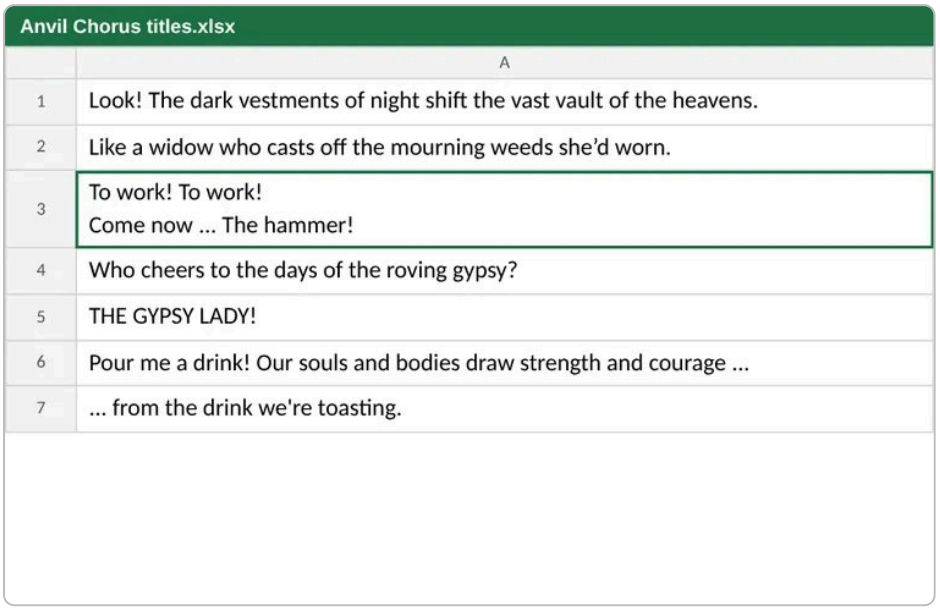


- **Paste:** with no slides yet, click the empty slide list and paste (`⌘V`) — one title per line, or a CSV list, or a copied PowerPoint, CSV or text file. The Import window opens with them in it, ready to check. Text copied from Word, Pages or a web page comes in clean: each paragraph becomes a slide, a line break inside a paragraph (`Shift`+`Return`) stays a line break inside the slide, and list bullets and hidden formatting are left out.
- **Choose a file…** opens a **.csv**, a tab-separated **.tsv**, a **.txt**, a **PowerPoint file** (.pptx) or a **PDF of existing slides** (its text is read page by page) — or paste the text into the box. Dropping one of these files on the window, or opening it with **File** → **Open…**, brings it here too.
- **From PowerPoint**, only the text comes in: each PowerPoint slide becomes one STQ slide, in order, with its line breaks. (Slide numbers, dates and footers are left out, and only .pptx works, not the older .ppt.) The text appears in the box as a CSV list first, so you can check it before you click **Import**.
- **Format: PowerPoint** — each PowerPoint slide becomes one slide. Choosing it opens the file chooser for a .pptx file (as does **Choose a file…**).

- **Format: CSV / TSV** — each spreadsheet cell becomes one slide, numbered in order. CSV uses commas between cells; TSV uses tabs. Put a CSV value in `"double quotes"` if it contains a comma. Commas inside a TSV cell stay in its title. `|` makes a line break inside a slide.
- **Format: Text** — every line becomes one slide.
- `(blank)` on its own stands for an empty slide, a blackout. A blank PowerPoint slide shows up this way, and STQ's own CSV and text exports write blank slides the same way, so they come back intact.
- **Existing slides:** replace them, or add the new ones to the end.

Tip: write your titles in a spreadsheet

Excel, Numbers and Google Sheets make a comfortable writing desk for titles: one cell per title, top to bottom in column A — easy to read, reorder and share with a translator.



One title per cell. Cell A3 holds a two-line title.

1. Type one title per cell, all in column A. Commas and quotation marks inside a title are fine.
2. For a line break inside a title, press `^⌥Return` in Excel on a Mac, or `Alt`+`Enter` on Windows (Numbers and Google Sheets have a similar shortcut). The break carries over to the slide.
3. Save or download the sheet as **CSV** (in Excel: **File** → **Save As** → **CSV UTF-8**, which keeps accents intact) or a UTF-8 **TSV** file.
4. In STQ, click **Import…**, choose the file and click **Import**. Each cell becomes one slide, in order.

> A sheet with numbers in column A and the titles in column B works too — STQ notices the numbering and uses the text column.

Fit to the screen

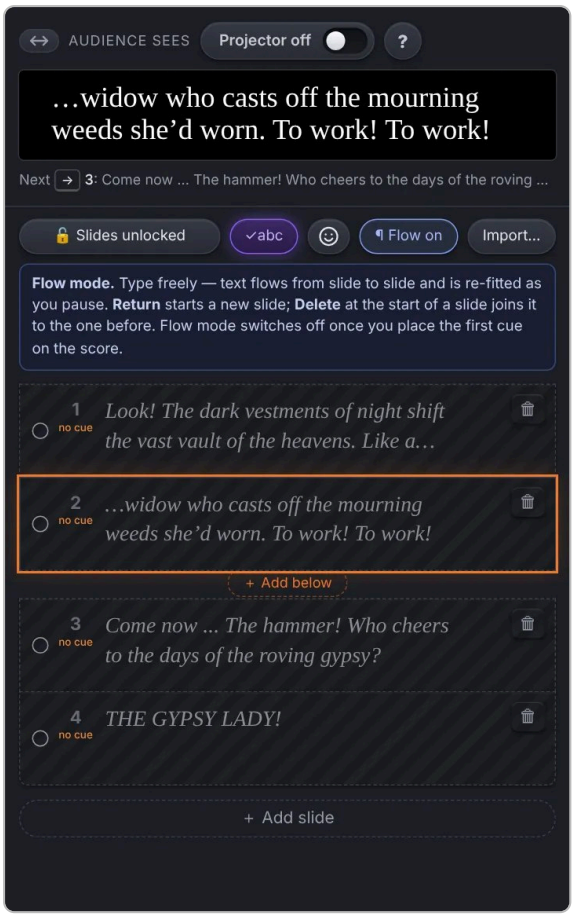
With **Fit to the screen** ticked, text that is too long for one slide is split over as many as it needs, up to the screen's line limit (6 lines on 16:9 and 4:3, 2 on the 6:1 strip). Sentences stay together when they can. A sentence that doesn't fit in what is left of a slide starts there and continues on the next slide, with "…" at both ends — unless fewer than two of its words would fit, then it starts the next slide.

Export slides (CSV) in the File menu writes all titles to a CSV file, for editing elsewhere or sharing with a translator.

Flow mode: paste the libretto, get the slides

The fastest way from a libretto to finished slides: paste the text and watch it lay itself out, slide by slide.

¶ Flow above the slides turns the slide list into one continuous text: type or paste the libretto and it fills the slides by itself.



- Paste plain text — one title per line, or the libretto as it is; no commas or quotation marks needed.
- **Pasting into a slide** keeps the pasted line breaks and handles extra text the same way as typing: overflow moves forward into the next connected slide, or into a new slide before the next manual break. Slides before the one you are editing stay unchanged.
- **Typing** works like a word processor: what you type stays exactly as you type it, spaces and line breaks included. Only when a slide is full do the words that don't fit move on to the next slide, like a new page, and the cursor goes with them.
- **Join slides** by pressing `Backspace` (the `Delete` key on a Mac) at the very start of a slide with no text selected. It joins to the slide before it across either a manual break or an automatic split, and extra text flows forward again. `Shift`+`Backspace` keeps the ordinary key behavior.
- Turning Flow on, changing its layout settings, or using **Import** → **Fit to the screen** still lays out whole text blocks by sentences. Pasting into a slide does not reorganize earlier slides.

⌨ IN FLOW MODE

`Return`	start a new slide at the cursor (replaces selected text)
`Shift` + `Return`	line break inside a slide
`Backspace` at the very start of a slide	join it to the slide before (Mac: `Delete`)

🔒 **Flow mode locks once cues are on the score.** As soon as the first cue is placed, Flow mode switches off and its **¶ Flow** button is grayed out, so titles that already belong to cues can never move. To use Flow mode again, remove all cues (**File** ▾ → **Remove all cue markers…**) — or keep editing the slides one by one, which always works.

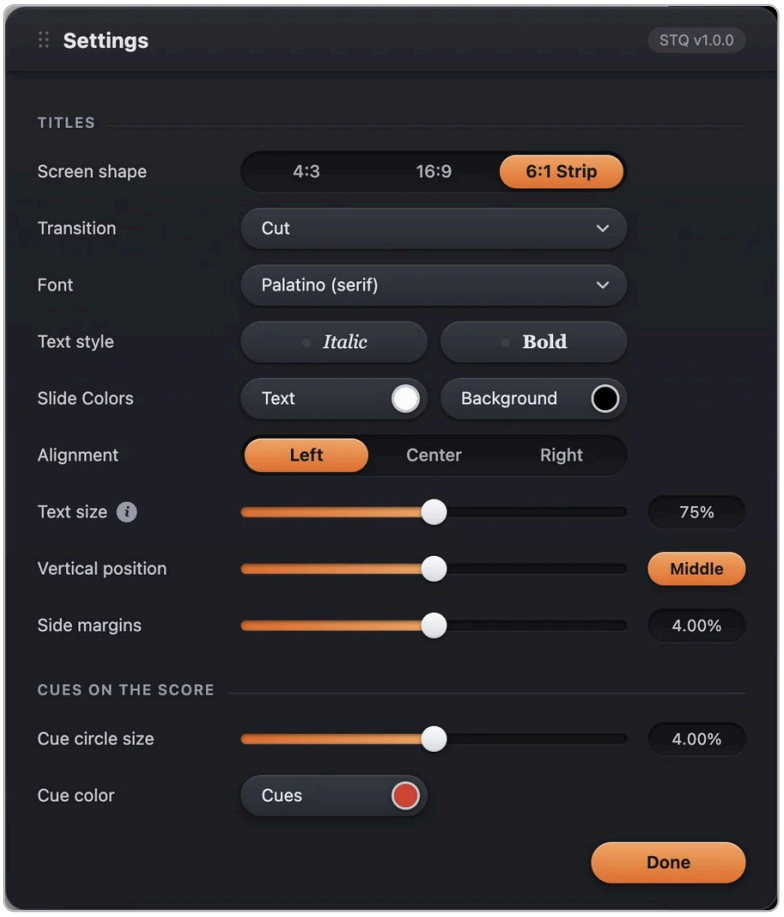
💡 **TIPS**

- The smoothest order: write or paste the whole libretto in Flow mode, read through the slides, and only then place the cues.
- Want a title to begin on a fresh slide no matter what? Put the cursor there and press `Return`.
- For a line break inside a slide — a verse line, say — use `Shift` + `Return`.
- A red slide is too long for the screen: shorten it, or press `Return` where it should split.
- Need to change words after the cues are placed? Just click a slide and type — editing one slide at a time always works.

Making the titles look just right

A few switches and sliders, and the preview shows every change instantly — no guessing what the audience will see.

The Settings window can be dragged anywhere by its title bar, so you can watch the **Audience sees** preview while you adjust (double-click the title bar to put it back in the middle). Every change applies at once; **Done** just closes the window. It has two parts: **Titles**, for how the supertitles look on the screen, and **Cues on the score**, for the numbered circles you place on the PDF.



Screen shape

16:9 fills a widescreen projector; **4:3** uses a centered 4:3 area; **6:1 Strip** is a full-width band one sixth as high as it is wide, for two lines of titles above the stage.

Projector on

Browser version only: **This screen** opens the audience window where you are, to drag onto the projector; **Screen 2** opens it straight on the second screen (Chrome asks your permission the first time).

Transition

How one title gives way to the next when you move to another cue:

- **Cut** (the default): the next title appears instantly.
- **Soft Cut**: a quick ⅙-second dissolve, just enough to take the edge off.
- **Dissolve**: a gentle 1-second dissolve from one title into the next.

- **Crossfade**: the title fades out in ⅔ of a second, then the next one fades in over another ⅔ of a second.

The preview shows the same transition as the projector. Going to a blank slide fades the title away. **Blackout** always cuts to black at once, and bringing the title back cuts too; after the last cue the final title simply stays up. If you press → again in the middle of a fade, the next fade starts from what is on the screen, with no jump.

Font, Text style, Slide Colors

Eight fonts that every Mac and Windows computer has: Georgia, Palatino, Times New Roman, Verdana, Arial, Trebuchet MS, Tahoma and Impact. So a project, and its PowerPoint export, look the same on any computer. Italic and bold, text and background color. Impact is already as heavy as a font gets and has no bold of its own, so with Impact the **Bold** button is grayed out and the titles look the same either way. (A project made with an older version in Garamond or Helvetica switches to Palatino or Arial when opened, and STQ says so.)

Alignment

Left (default), center or right.

Text size

50 % to 100 % (new projects start at 75 %, the middle of the slider). 100 % is the built-in layout (titles about 137 pixels high on an HD projector). At smaller sizes the lines and the spaces between them shrink together, a title still has room for 2 lines on the 6:1 strip and 6 on the other shapes, and the height that frees up goes to the top and bottom margins. Hover over the little **i** for the exact numbers. The size never changes with the amount of text.

Vertical position

A slider from top (left) to bottom (right), starting in the middle. The button beside it shows how far up or down the titles sit; click it to put them back in the **Middle**. On the 6:1 strip it moves the whole strip up or down the projector screen.

Side margins

2 % to 6 % of the width on each side (new projects start in the middle, at 4 %).

Cue circle size

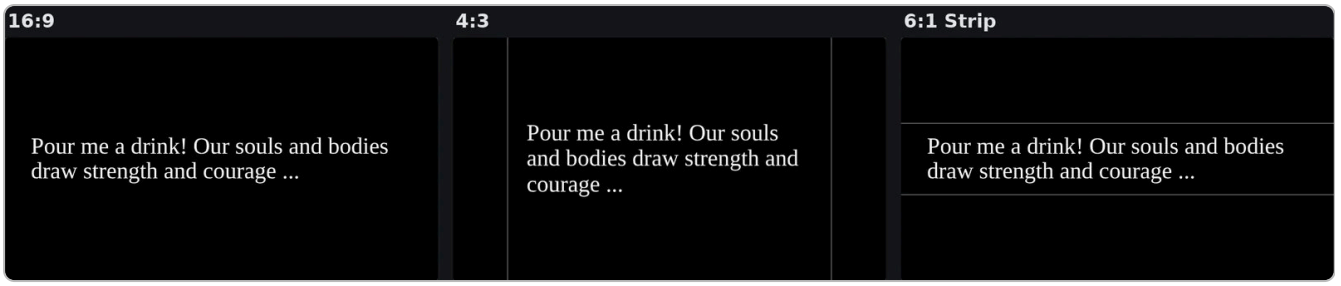
2 to 6 (default 4, the middle).

Cue color

The color of all the cue circles on the score — and in the printable score. Click **Cues** to choose any color, just like the text and background colors; it starts at the standard red. (The current cue is always highlighted in orange while you work, whatever color you pick.) A cue whose slide is colored with “Also color its cue” shows the slide's color instead (see Color-coding slides and cues).

Spelling language

Windows desktop app only.



With the projector on, the preview shows the whole projector screen; thin lines (on your screen only) mark the 4:3 area or the 6:1 strip.

💡 **TIPS FOR TITLES PEOPLE CAN READ FROM THE BACK ROW**

- White (or warm off-white) on black is the classic for a reason: the black disappears in a dark theatre and only the words float above the stage.
- Serif fonts like Georgia and Palatino read easily at a distance; Arial and Verdana look cleaner on a bright LED wall. Tahoma and Times New Roman are narrow, so more words fit on a line: handy for the 6:1 strip.
- 75 % is a good starting size: big enough for the back row, with dark space around the titles so they don't crowd the stage.
- For the transition, **Soft Cut** feels calm without ever making the audience wait; save **Dissolve** and **Crossfade** for slow, lyrical scenes.
- Walk to the last row during a technical rehearsal and read a few titles. If you squint, go up a size or switch to bold.
- On a 6:1 strip above the proscenium, keep titles short — two lines is all there is, and the audience is looking up.
- Drag the Settings window to one side so the **Audience sees** preview stays in view while you try things.

The quickest way to connect your projector

One cable and one setting, and you're ready — here's how, step by step.

> This page is always one click away: the **?** button right next to the **Projector** switch opens it.

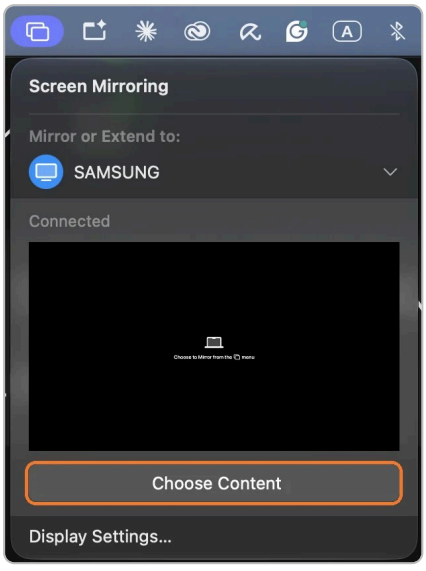
The projector (or TV) must be a **second, extended screen** — not a mirror of yours, or the audience would see the whole app. A cable is the reliable way: HDMI, or USB-C to HDMI on laptops with only USB-C. Wireless casting lags and can drop out.

Mac

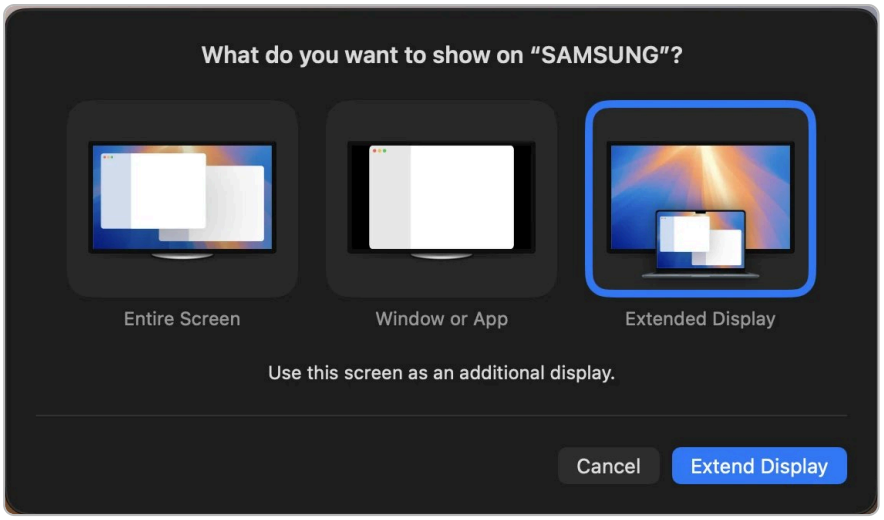
1. **Connect** your Mac to the projector (HDMI, or USB-C to HDMI) and turn the projector on.
2. Click the **Screen Mirroring** icon — two overlapping rectangles — in the menu bar at the top of the screen.



3. In the Screen Mirroring window that opens, click **Choose Content**.



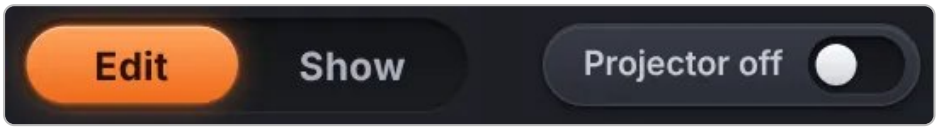
4. In the next window, click **Extended Display**, then **Extend Display**.



5. In STQ, flip the **Projector** switch on. The audience view opens full screen on the projector.



> No Screen Mirroring icon in the menu bar? It's also in Control Center (the switches icon at the top right). Then test: choose **Show** and press `→`.



Edit / **Show** switches the mode; the **Projector** switch opens the audience window — it glows teal while the projector is live.

⌨ PROJECTOR AND MODES

`⇧⌘E` / `⇧⌘R`	Edit / Show mode (desktop app)
`F`	full screen on / off, in the projector window

Windows

1. Plug in the projector and turn it on.
2. Press `Windows`+`P` and choose **Extend** (not Duplicate). Not showing?
   Settings → System → Display → Multiple displays → Detect.
3. Plug in the charger; the desktop app keeps the PC awake in Show mode. Turn on **Do not disturb**.
4. Flip the **Projector** switch on and test with **Show** and `→`, as on the Mac.

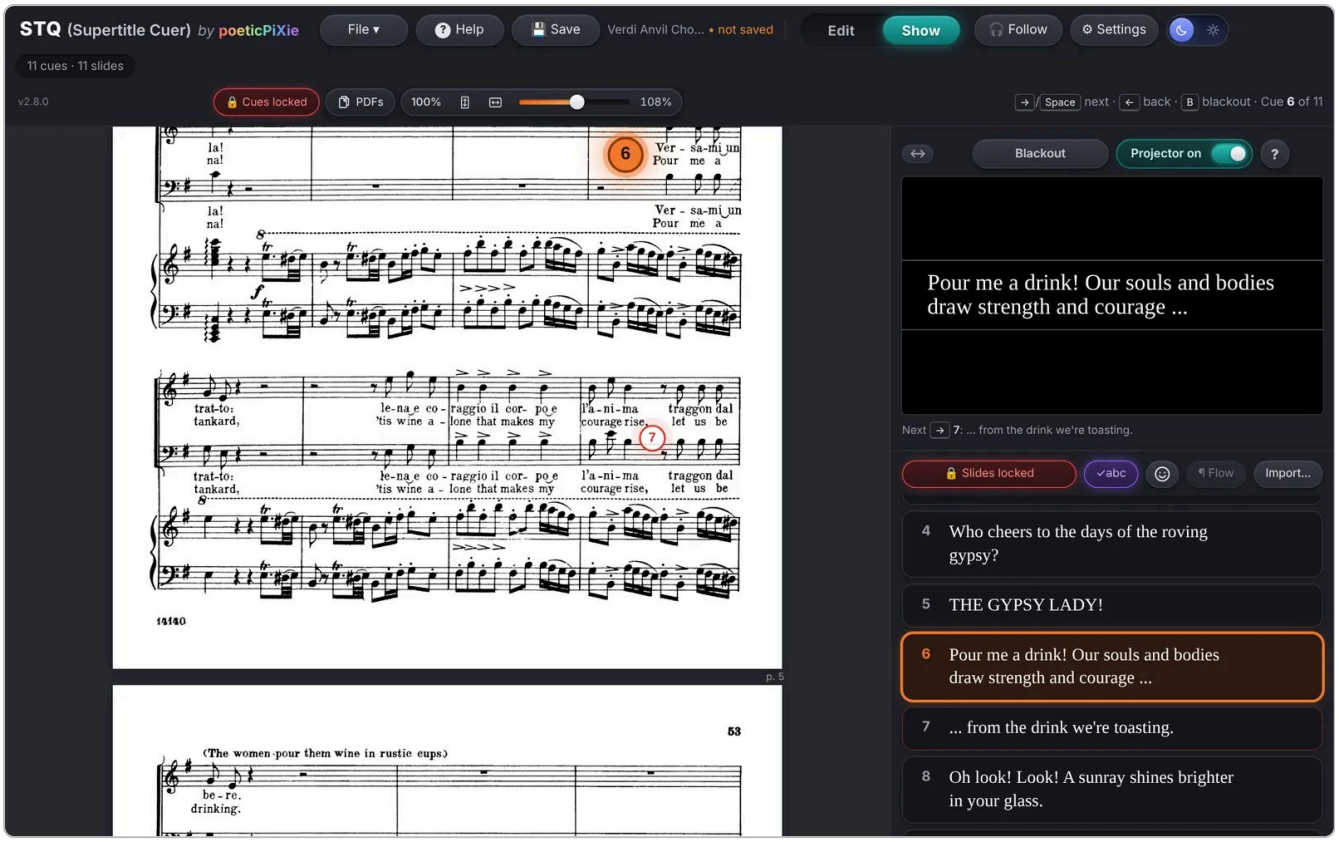
> The same steps are always one click away under **? Help**. Without a projector you can still rehearse: the projector window opens as an ordinary window on your own screen.

💡 **TIPS**

- Set up and test at the venue before the house opens: plug in, extend, open the projector, press `→` once.
- Plug in the power adapter. The desktop app keeps the computer and both screens awake by itself in Show mode.
- If the audience view ever lands on your own screen, choose **View → Move Projector to Second Screen**. In the browser version, drag the projector window onto the projector and press `F` (or double-click it).
- Bring your own USB-C to HDMI adapter — and a spare. Venue adapters have a way of disappearing.
- Turn on Do Not Disturb, so no notification can ever pop up on the audience screen.
- Closed the projector window by accident? flipping the **Projector** switch on again brings it straight back, showing the current title.
- A presentation clicker lets you cue while your eyes stay on the score.
- No projector yet? Rehearse anyway: the projector window opens on your own screen, and `F` makes it full screen.

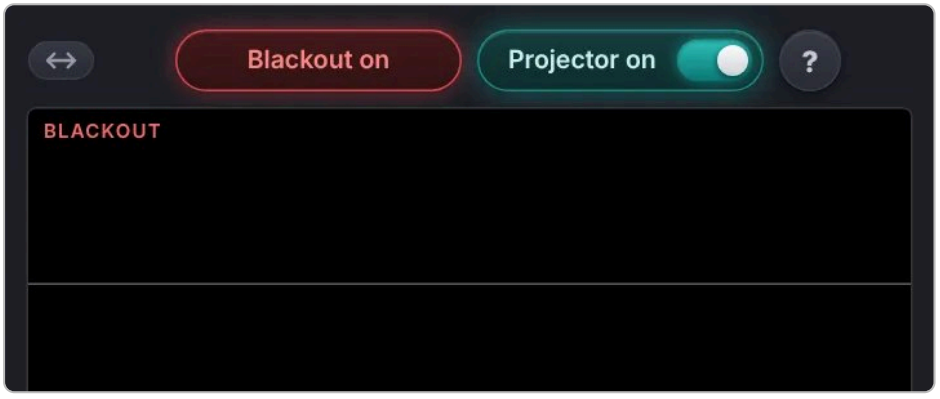
Show time! Running the titles live

The fun part: follow the score and press one key at each cue. STQ takes care of everything else.



Click **Show**. The slide text can no longer be changed, and the keyboard runs the titles. To jump somewhere else, click a slide in the list, or use ↑ ↓ after clicking in the list. Each new title comes in with the Transition chosen in Settings: a plain cut unless you pick Soft Cut, Dissolve or Crossfade.

While the projector is on, a **Blackout** button sits next to the Projector switch. Click it (or press B) and the audience screen goes empty at once, whatever the transition; it glows red until you click it again to bring the title back.

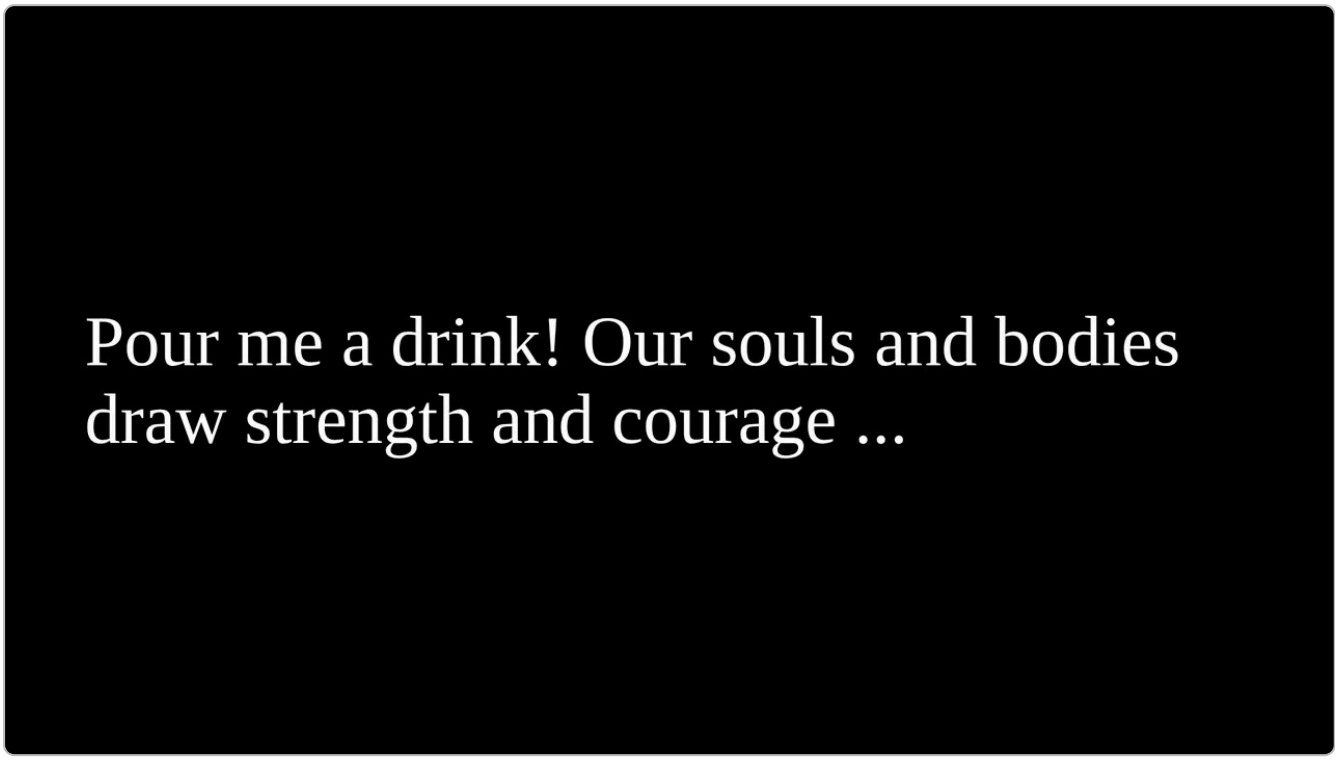


With the projector on, **Blackout** and the **Projector** switch sit side by side above the preview. Here the blackout is on: it glows red, and the preview shows what the audience sees — nothing.

⌨ RUNNING THE SHOW (SHOW MODE)

`→` `Space` `Page Down`	next title (a presentation clicker works too)
`←` `Page Up`	previous title
`B` or `.`	blackout: the screen goes empty; press again to bring the title back
`Home`	back to the start, before cue 1 (empty screen)

- The current cue glows orange on the score and the next one pulses; the score scrolls along by itself.
- **Next** → under the preview shows the coming title.
- Clicking a cue on the score or a slide's number jumps straight to it.
- The arrow keys also work while the projector window is in front.
- While the projector is open, the preview mirrors the whole projector screen at its real proportions; on 4:3 and 6:1, thin guide lines (only on your screen) mark the title area.

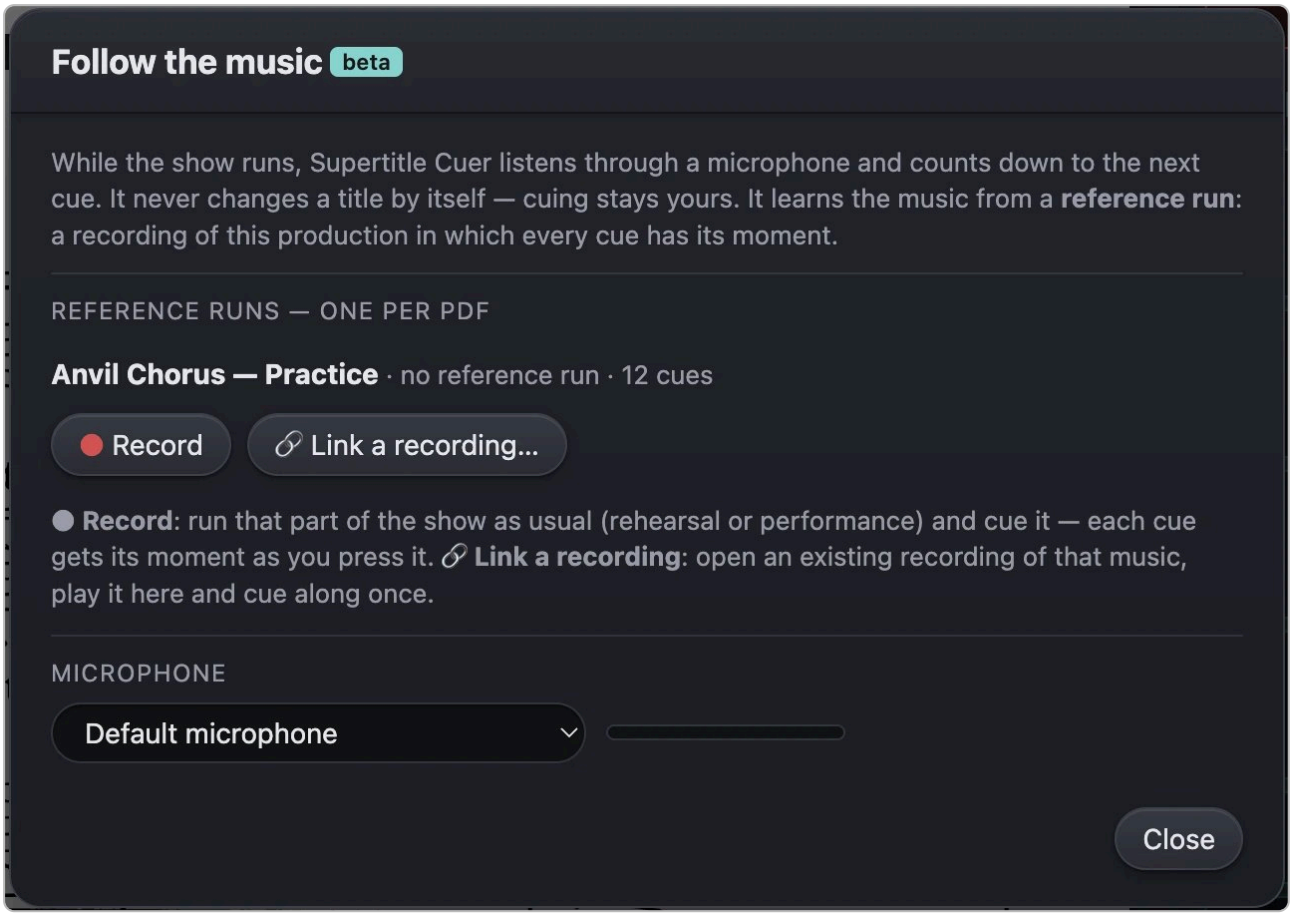


The projector window: only the title, nothing else.

Let STQ follow the music with you

Experimental timing guidance: it listens along and estimates the time until the next cue. Check the score and cue manually.

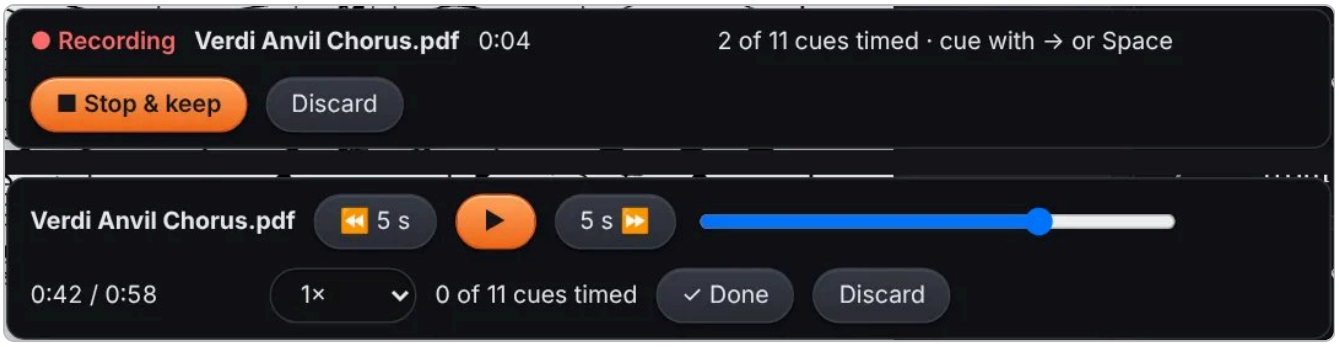
Follow listens through a microphone during the performance and estimates the next cue — “Estimated cue 7 in ~4.2 s” — while you change each title yourself. Estimates can drift even without a warning and with a closely matching recording; use the score to decide when to cue. It learns the music from a **reference run**, a recording in which every cue has its moment. Each PDF of the score has its own reference run, so Act 1 and Act 2 can be prepared separately. The separate **Auto** button can advance prepared cues automatically, as described below. The app does not yet read music notation or sung lyrics.



Making a reference run

Either on a PDF's card in the **PDFs** panel or in 🎧 **Follow**:

- ● **Record** — records that PDF's music through the microphone while you run it (a rehearsal or a performance) and cue it as usual. Every cue you press gets its moment. Press ■ **Stop & keep** at the end.
- 🔗 **Link…** — opens an existing recording of that music (mp3, m4a, wav, aiff, flac, ogg, webm or a video). It plays in the app — with ⏪ **5 s**, ▶/⏸, **5 s** ⏩, a position slider and 1×, 1.25× or 1.5× speed — and you cue along once. Press ✓ **Done** at the end.

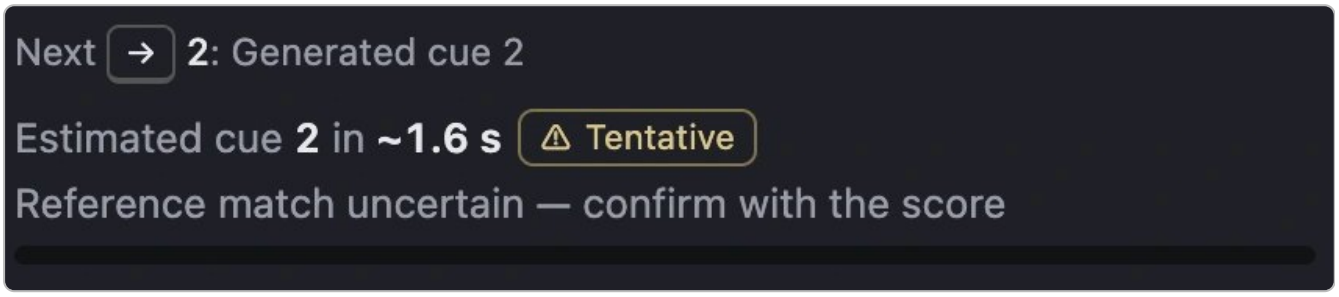


Both switch to Show mode and start just before that PDF's first cue. Only that PDF's cues get times, and only when you move forward: ← to go back doesn't change any times. To fix a cue, go back to the one before it (in a linked recording, rewind the player too) and press → again at the right moment — the last press counts. A recording made in the app is kept inside the project file (about 15 MB per hour); a linked recording stays where it is and only the cue times and the analysis of the music are saved.

Done / Stop & keep commits the recording analysis and the new cue times together. **Discard** leaves the previous reference and cue times intact. Saving during a run ends and keeps that run first. Finish the run before editing cues, slides or PDFs. Undo and Redo restore the reference together with its cue times.

Following during the show

1. Choose the microphone in 🎧 **Follow**; the meter shows that it hears. Place it where it hears the stage and the orchestra, not the audience.
2. Click **Start following**, then run the show as always.
3. The countdown appears under the preview:



The estimate stays visible with ⚠ **Tentative** while the reference match is uncertain.

Estimated cue 7 in ~4.2 s
: The bar shows an approximate time from the reference match. For a clear match it turns orange near the estimated cue; tempo is shown on the right. This is not a guarantee of alignment.

Estimated cue 7 reached
: A clear match estimates that the cue has been reached. Confirm with the score and cue manually.

⚠ Tentative
: The match is uncertain. The number stays visible with a steady warning instead of disappearing. Continue cuing from the score; your next timed cue re-syncs the reference. Recovery can take time or fail.

Paused
: After a little over a second of quiet or unclear audio, the displayed countdown freezes until clearer music returns. The number remains visible. Tentative and Paused estimates do not show the stronger near-cue or reached signals.

Next cue starts “Act 2.pdf”
: The next cue is in another PDF; Follow switches to that PDF's recording when you cue it.

Every timed cue you press re-syncs it. Use a reference with matching music, key, cuts and repeats. Treat Follow as experimental assistance. Practice with the countdown in view and use manual cueing for the performance.

Automatic cueing with Auto

Click or right-click a section heading and choose **Auto recording…** or **Auto live (beta)** at the top of its menu. These launch that section even when another cue is selected. They are unavailable until it has a reference run and every cue has a valid time in cue order.

The toolbar's ▶ **Auto** ▾ runs the section of the current numbered cue. Scrolling the score alone does not change that target; select a cue or use the section's own menu.

- **Auto recording…** plays the reference and changes later titles at their saved times. Recordings made in STQ are inside the project. For linked audio, choose the original file when asked; STQ verifies its contents. Keep that file available after reopening. Use **Pause** / **Resume** to pause and continue.
- **Auto live (beta)** follows the visible numeric estimate, including ⚠ **Tentative** with its warning. Fresh estimates must agree on the due title for about 0.2 seconds before advancing. Silence or a **Paused** estimate holds the title; usable estimates let it continue without restarting. A forward estimate catches up directly to the current title; Auto never moves backwards. It uses the saved analysis, so linked audio need not be open. Use **Pause Auto** / **Resume Auto** to pause and continue.

Your launch click shows the first title. When the recording loads or live mode starts, the section's first title appears immediately, regardless of its saved time. Later titles follow the recording clock or live estimate. Saved cue times are unchanged.

Both modes start the section from the beginning. Press `Space`, use the arrows or click a cue or slide to take over: recording playback stops, while live mode continues as ordinary Follow. Press `Esc` or **Stop Auto** to stop.

Auto stops at the section's end. Launch each next prepared section with a fresh click. Sections without a reference run stay manual, with Auto unavailable.

> **Live Auto is experimental.** Matching can drift even without a warning and may put up the wrong title. Watch the score and press `Space` to take over whenever needed.

Saving your work (and finding it again)

One file holds the whole production, so there is nothing to lose track of.

💾 **Save** (`⌘S`) and **File** ▾ → **Save As…** (`⇧⌘S`) write the project as one `.supertitles` file. Double-click it to open it in the desktop app, or open it with **File** ▾ → **Open…** (`⌘O`) or by dropping it on the window. Opening a project locks its cues and slides, so nothing changes by accident.

- After a normal close, the desktop app starts on the welcome screen with nothing open. Open a project by double-clicking its file, using **File** → **Open…**, or dropping it on the window. If a previous session ended unexpectedly with unsaved work, the app asks *Recover unsaved work from the previous session?* Choose **Recover** to restore its cached score, titles, cues, settings and completed reference runs, then save the recovered project; **Start Fresh** discards that draft. The browser version picks up where you left off. A saved file is still the copy to move to another computer or back up.
- **Undo** `⌘Z` and **Redo** `⇧⌘Z` (`Ctrl`+`Y` on Windows) cover cues, slides, and moved or removed PDFs.
- The desktop app asks before closing with unsaved changes; "• not saved" next to the project name shows there are some.
- **File** ▾ → **Close project** (`⌘W`) closes the project and returns to the welcome screen, offering to save unsaved changes first. On a Mac, STQ then works like Word: closing the window (or `⌘W` again with nothing open) leaves STQ running in the Dock and menu bar, ready for the next file. Click its Dock icon for the welcome screen, double-click a project to open it, and quit with `⌘Q`. On Windows, closing the window quits STQ, as Windows apps do. **File** ▾ → **New project…** (`⌘N`) does the same and starts empty. **Remove all cue markers…** and **Remove all slides…** clear one side only.

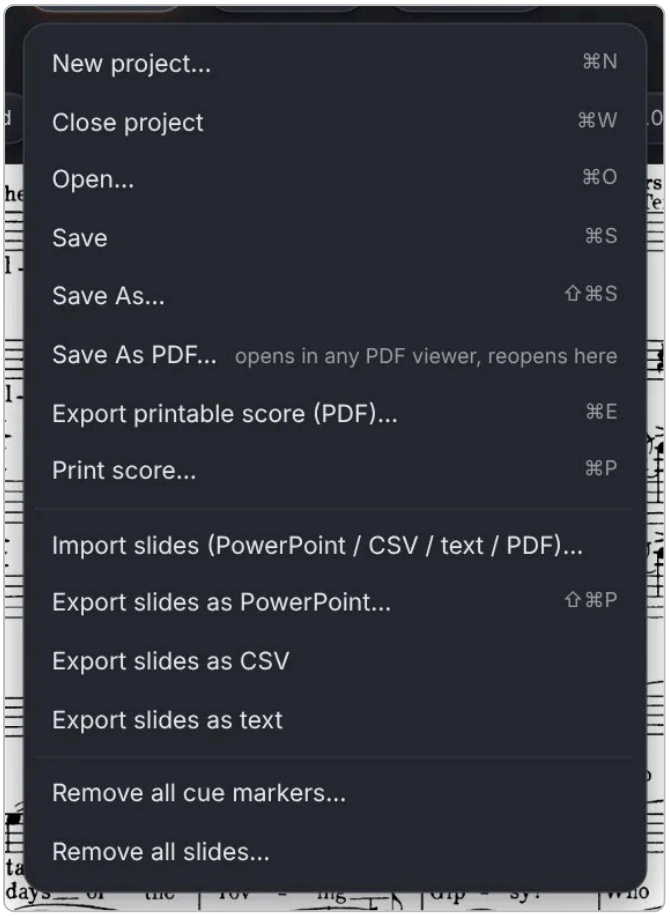
⌨ FILES

`⌘S`	save
`⇧⌘S`	save as
`⌥⇧⌘S`	save as PDF (desktop app)
`⌘O`	open
`⌘W`	close project (desktop app)
`⌘E`	export printable score (desktop app)
`⌘Z` / `⇧⌘Z`	undo / redo

The different files Supertitle Cuer can write are explained in the next chapter, Sharing and printing.

Sharing and printing: what each export gives you

Need a copy for the conductor, a printout for the booth, or a list for the translator? There's a one-click export for each.



Everything is in the **File** ▾ menu (and the desktop app's **File** menu). There are six kinds of file:

Command	File	Holds	Opens again in Supertitle Cuer?
Save / **Save As…**	`Name.supertitles`	The whole project	Yes, everything editable
Save As PDF…	`Name – supertitles.pdf`	The whole project, inside a PDF anyone can read	Yes, everything editable
Export printable score (PDF)…	`Name – printable.pdf`	The score with numbered cues, and a cue sheet	Only as a plain score
Export slides as PowerPoint…	`Name – supertitles.pptx`	One slide per supertitle, looking just as on the projector	No

Export slides as CSV	`Name – slides.csv`	The titles only	Through **Import…**
Export slides as text	`Name – slides.txt`	The titles only, one per line	Through **Import…**

The project file (.supertitles)

Everything about the production, in one file: the score PDF (all its parts, merged), the cues, every title, the display settings, and the reference runs for Follow — including recordings made in the app.

Save at any stage. A project can hold a score with no titles yet, titles with no score yet, or both, and **Save** works the same in every case. **No score yet?** A project with only titles saves as a normal `.supertitles` file too; opened in a PDF viewer it shows a numbered list of the titles. Open it in STQ, add the score PDF whenever it arrives, and **Save** puts everything into the same file. The PowerPoint, CSV and text exports work without a score as well.

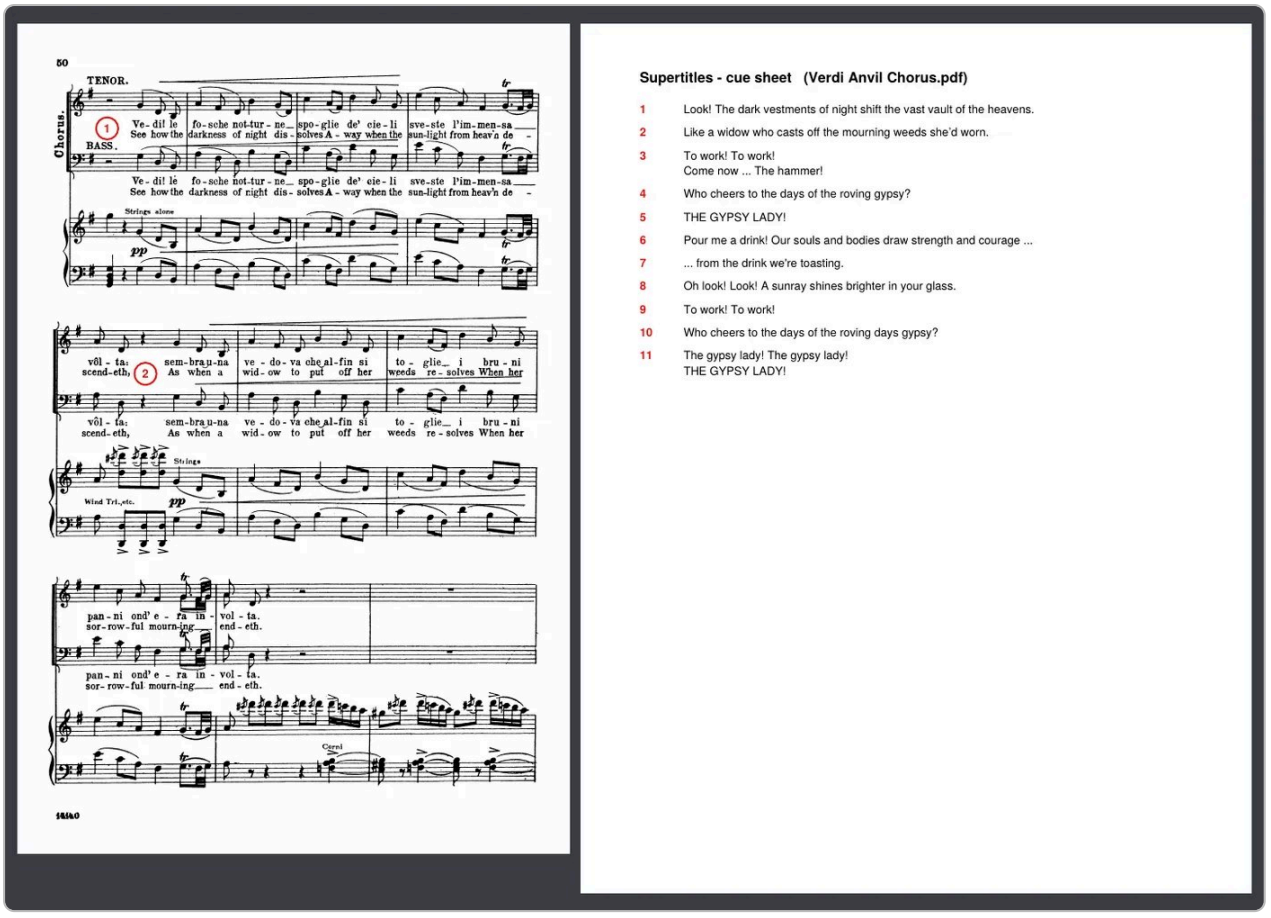
This is the file to keep, back up and take to the theatre. A `.supertitles` file is a PDF inside, but it is meant to be opened with Supertitle Cuer.

Save As PDF

The same complete project — including the cue times, Follow's reference runs and recordings made in the app — saved with a `.pdf` ending so that anyone can open it in any PDF viewer — Preview, Acrobat, a browser, a tablet. In a viewer it shows the score with the numbered red cues on its pages, followed by the cue sheet. Opened in Supertitle Cuer, it is the full, editable project again. Use it to share a production with a conductor, stage manager or translator who doesn't have the app, without keeping two files.

Export printable score

A plain PDF made for printing: the score pages with the numbered cues drawn on them (at the **Cue circle size** from Settings), and at the end a **cue sheet** listing every title next to its number — red numbers for cued titles, gray for titles that have no cue yet. It contains no project data, so it is small and safe to send anywhere; opened in Supertitle Cuer it is just a score. Use it for the booth binder, the conductor's or stage manager's copy, or to proofread the titles on paper.



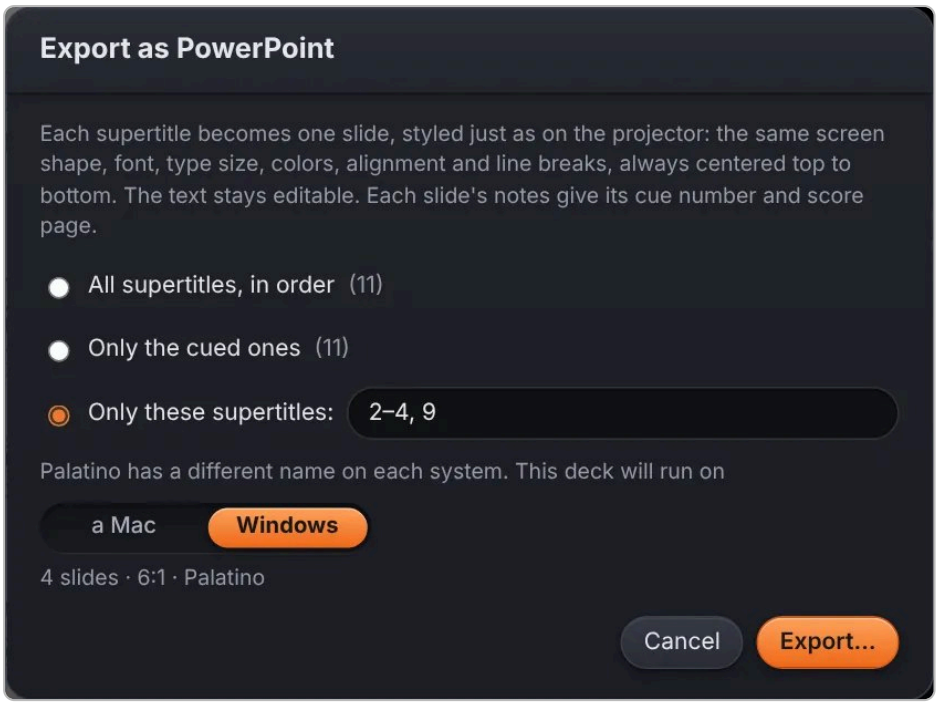
The printable score: a page with its numbered cues, and the cue sheet at the end.

Export slides as PowerPoint

Some theatres run their titles from PowerPoint, and some operators only know PowerPoint. **File** ▾ → **Export slides as PowerPoint…** (⇧⌘P) turns the supertitles into a PowerPoint presentation, one slide per supertitle, in order. It is also a good backup: if the show laptop fails, any computer with PowerPoint can run the titles.

- **It looks like the projector.** The slides have the same shape as your screen (16:9, 4:3 or the 6:1 strip) and the same font, type size, italic or bold, text and background colors, alignment and side margins. Each title breaks its lines exactly where STQ does.
- **Always centered top to bottom.** Every title sits in the vertical middle of its slide, whatever **Vertical position** is set to in STQ, so it looks the same in PowerPoint, Keynote or Google Slides.
- **The text stays editable.** Each title is an ordinary PowerPoint text box, so a typo can be fixed there. PowerPoint won't rewrap the lines, so if you make a line longer, break it yourself with `Return`.
- **Choose what goes in: All supertitles, in order** (including any still waiting for a cue), **Only the cued ones**, or **Only these supertitles**: type their numbers, such as “1–20, 25”.
- **Speaker notes.** Each slide's notes say its cue number and score page (and, with several PDFs, which one), so whoever runs the slides can follow along in a printed score. Uncued lines say “Not cued yet”.
- **Blank supertitles** become empty slides in your background color, so a blackout stays a blackout. A title too long for the screen is cut just as on the projector, and its notes hold the full text.

- **Palatino** is called “Palatino” on a Mac and “Palatino Linotype” on Windows. When your font is Palatino, the export asks which kind of computer the slides will run on, so PowerPoint finds the font by its right name. The other six fonts have the same name everywhere.



Exporting supertitles 2–4 and 9 for a Windows computer.

> Keynote and Google Slides open the file too. To run the show from PowerPoint, start the slide show from the first slide and press `→` or `Space` for each cue, just as in STQ.

Printing

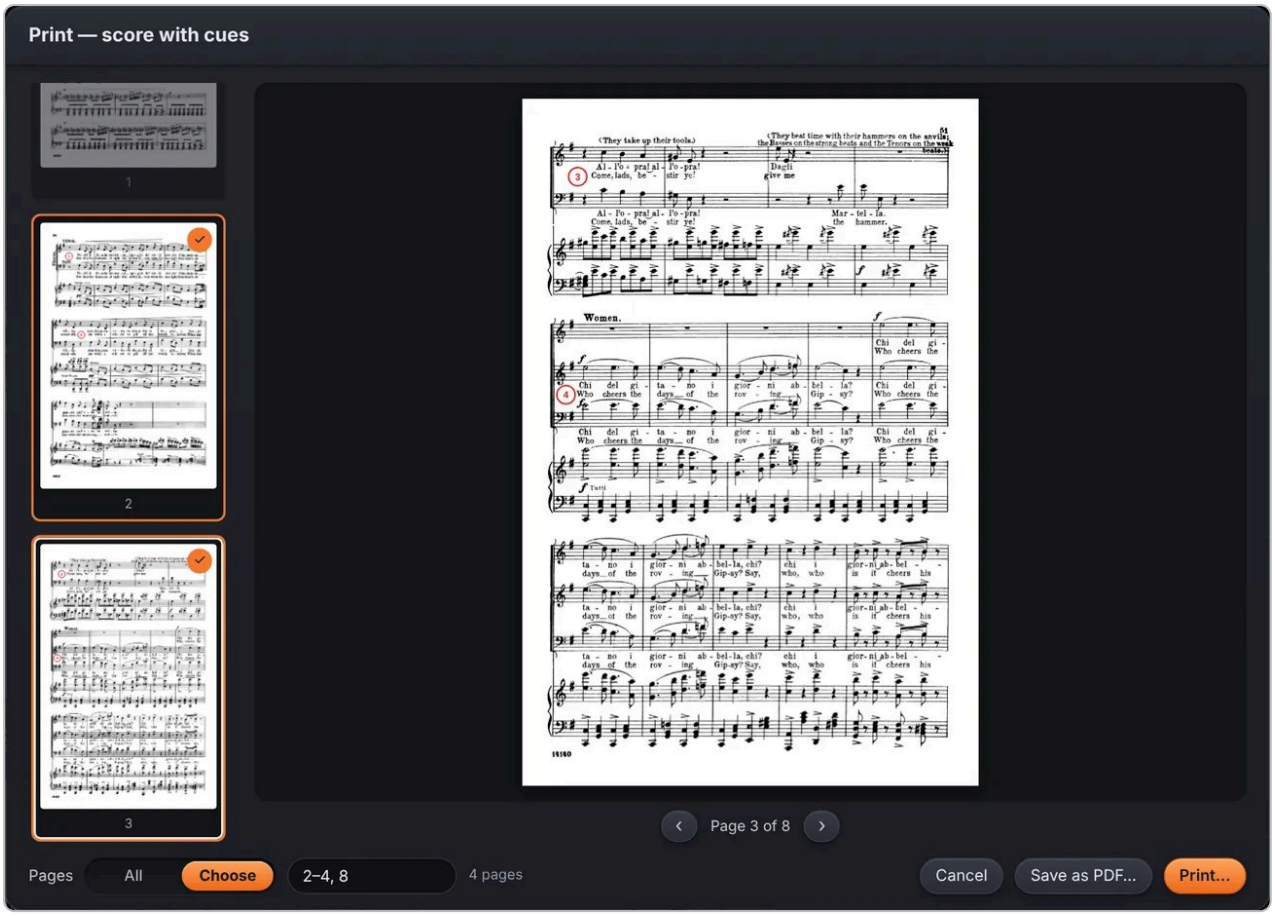
Two things can go to the printer straight from STQ:

- **The score** — **File** ▾ → **Print score…** (`⌘P`). Exactly what **Export printable score** makes: every PDF rolled into one, the numbered cues in their colors, and the cue sheet at the end.
- **This guide** — **Help** → **Print the Guide…** in the desktop app's menu bar, or 🖨 **Print the guide** at the bottom of the Help panel's contents. ⬇ **Save as PDF** next to it (and **Help** → **Save the Guide as PDF…**) saves the guide as a PDF file instead.

In the desktop app both open STQ's **print preview** first: every page as a thumbnail down the left, the page you click shown large on the right, and a choice at the bottom:

- **All** pages, or **Choose** — type the pages you want (“2–4, 8”) or tick them on the thumbnails; `Shift`-tick to take a whole run. Pages left out are dimmed, so you see exactly what will print, and the count updates as you go.
- **Print…** then opens your computer's own print dialog — the same one Word, Pages or Acrobat use — for the printer, copies, two-sided printing and paper, with just the chosen pages.
- **Save as PDF…** saves just the chosen pages as a PDF file instead.

Use the arrow keys or the ‹ › buttons to page through, and `Esc` to close without printing.



The print preview with pages 2–4 and 8 chosen: the others are dimmed, and the count says 4 pages.

> In the single-file HTML version the browser prints instead, with its own print preview — the same choices are there under “More settings”.

PRINTING TIPS

- For the booth binder, print the score two-sided and the cue sheet single-sided, as a separate job — it's easier to keep on the desk next to the laptop.
- Need the cue sheet only? Print just its pages: they are always the last ones.
- Cues looking small on paper? Raise **Cue circle size** in Settings before printing.

Export slides as CSV

All the titles as a CSV file: one title per line, each in double quotes (an empty title as `(blank)`), numbered by their order; line breaks inside a title are kept. It opens in Excel, Numbers or Google Sheets (with accents intact), so a translator can work on the titles. Bring it back with **Import…** (Format: CSV) — choose **Replace** to swap in the new version. The cues are not affected.

Export slides as text

All the titles as plain text, one title per line: a line break inside a title is written as `|` and an empty title as `(blank)`. Handy for a quick read-through or an email. Bring it back with **Import…** (Format: Text).

> Recordings linked with 🔗 **Link…** stay where they are on your computer; only the cue times and Follow's analysis of the music are saved with the project.

What if a linked recording moves?

The saved cue times and Follow's analysis of the music stay inside the project. Ordinary Follow and Auto's live microphone mode use that analysis, so moving the linked recording or opening the project on another computer does not remove their reference. The project keeps the recording's name and verified identity, rather than its location or audio.

You need the original file again for Auto recording playback or to cue along a second time. Choose it when asked; STQ checks the file contents. To fix a cue in a verified recording, jump to the passage, re-time it and press ✓ **Done**; unreplayed analysis and other cue times are kept. A different recording starts a new timeline when kept, even if its length or filename matches. Older projects without a verified recording identity require one fresh complete pass. Keep the player running through the whole piece for that pass.

💡 **SHARING TIPS**

- A project with a long score and recordings can be large — share it through a cloud link (iCloud Drive, Dropbox, Google Drive) rather than as an email attachment.
- Keep one master project file and date your copies (“Trovatore 2026-10-15.supertitles”), so everyone knows which version is the latest.
- Before sending a printable score, glance at the cue colors and the Cue circle size in Settings — they print exactly as they look.
- A backup on a USB stick in the booth costs nothing and has saved many a performance.

More examples from real productions

A few everyday situations, and the quickest way through each.

A cut at the last rehearsal

1. Switch to **Edit** (it unlocks the cues and slides).
2. Click the first title of the cut, `Shift`-click the last, then 🗑 **Delete…**. Tick *Also delete associated cues* so cues and titles stay paired.
3. Switch back to **Show** — everything locks again — and save.

A backup laptop in the booth

1. Save the project, and copy the `.supertitles` file (or a Save-As-PDF copy) to the second computer.
2. Open it there: same score, cues, titles and look. Leave it on the current cue during the show, ready to take over.

Touring: a different screen at every venue

1. At the new venue, open ⚙ **Settings** and pick the **Screen shape** — 16:9, 4:3 or the 6:1 strip.
2. Every slide is checked against the new shape at once; any that are now too long turn red, so you can fix them before the house opens.
3. Use **Vertical position** to lift the titles clear of the set, and drag the Settings window aside to watch the preview while you do.

One score, one printout, nothing else

No projector at all — just a marked score for the pit? See All you need is one score PDF with every cue numbered?.

Handy keyboard shortcuts

All the shortcuts in one place — keep this page handy in the booth.

> On Windows, use `Ctrl` where the Mac uses `⌘`.

SHOW MODE	
`↑` `↓`	Previous / next slide (after clicking the slide list)
`→` `Space` `Page Down`	Next title
`←` `Page Up`	Previous title
`B` `.`	Blackout on / off
`Home`	Back to before cue 1
`Esc`	Stop Auto; a manual cue also takes over immediately
`F` (in the projector window)	Full screen on / off
EDIT MODE	
`←` `↑` `→` `↓`	Nudge the selected cue 5 px (after clicking the score)
`Shift` + arrows	Nudge 25 px
`↑` `↓`	Previous / next slide (after clicking the slide list)
`Delete`	Delete the selected cue (or the selected range of slides)
`Shift`-click a slide	Select a range of slides
`⌘C` / `⌘V`	Copy selected slides / paste them after the selected slide (outside text editing)
`Esc`	Stop typing / clear the selection
ANYWHERE	
`⌘S` / `⇧⌘S`	Save / Save As
`⌥⇧⌘S`	Save As PDF (desktop app)
`⌘O`	Open
`⌘N`	New project (desktop app)
`⌘W`	Close project (desktop app)
`⌘E`	Export printable score (desktop app)
`⇧⌘P`	Export slides as PowerPoint (desktop app)
`⌘Z` / `⇧⌘Z`	Undo / Redo

`⇧⌘E` / `⇧⌘R`	Edit / Show mode (desktop app)
`⌘0` / `⌘1` / `⌘2`	score view: actual size (100%) / fit the page height / fit the page width
`⌘P`	Print the score with its cues and the cue sheet
`⌘,`	Settings (desktop app)
`⌘?`	Help (desktop app)

💡 **TIPS**

- Print the shortcuts page and keep it next to the laptop in the booth.
- The show keys also work while the projector window is in front — no need to click back into the main window first.
- Most presentation clickers send `→` or `Page Down`, so they work straight out of the box.
- `B` (blackout) is your safety net: if a wrong title goes up, press `B`, find the right one, and bring it back.
- Just before curtain up, press `Home`: the screen starts empty and the first `→` shows title 1.
- On Windows, read `Ctrl` wherever this guide shows `⌘` — the Help inside the app shows Ctrl for you.

Something not quite right? Quick fixes

Most hiccups have a one-click fix — STQ is rarely more than a click away from working again. Find yours below.

The projector shows my whole screen
The display is mirrored. Set it to extended (see The quickest way to connect your projector).

The projector window opened on my own screen
Desktop app: **View** → **Move Projector to Second Screen**. Browser: drag it to the projector and press `F`, or set **Settings** → **Projector on** to **Screen 2** so it opens there next time.

The arrow keys don't change the title
Make sure **Show** is selected and click once in the main window so it has the keyboard. In Edit mode the arrow keys nudge cues or step through slides instead.

Clicking the score does nothing
The cues are locked (opening a project locks them). Click the red 🔒 **Cues locked** button over the score (or switch to **Edit**). In Show mode clicks select cues instead of adding them.

I can't type in, move or delete a slide
The slides are locked: click 🔒 **Slides locked** above the slides.

A slide is red
Its text is longer than the screen allows; the gray words won't be shown. Shorten it, split it, or use a smaller text size or wider screen shape.

A cue circle is dashed, or a slide says “no cue”
There are more cues than slides, or more slides than cues. Add the missing titles or cues.

Flow mode is grayed out
It switches off once cues are on the score, so cued titles never move.

Follow stays Waiting or Paused
The microphone may be silent, or the audio may lack clear pitch information. Check the meter in 🎧 **Follow**, move the microphone where it hears the performers and, on a Mac, check **System Settings** → **Privacy & Security** → **Microphone**. Continue cuing from the score.

Auto is grayed out
Select a cue in the section you want to run. That section needs a reference run and a valid time for every cue, in order. Finish and keep a complete reference run in 🎧 **Follow** first.

Auto recording playback asks for a file
Linked audio is not embedded in the project. Choose the same original recording; its contents must match the saved reference. A matching filename alone is not enough.

macOS says the app is damaged or can't be opened
Run the `xattr` command from the install chapter, or install with Homebrew.